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Virginia Board of Education, Board Retreat, Tuesday, April 23, 2024

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- Official meeting video (VDOE, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=-6k1Bn8bfR4
- Board of Education meetings, agendas and minutes (VDOE): https://www.doe.virginia.gov/state-board-data-funding/virginia-board-of-education

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Speech-to-text: whisper.cpp, model large-v3-turbo. Produced 2026-10-23. Each paragraph starts with its time [HH:MM:SS] in the meeting video.

[00:09:19] Okay, good morning. I hope this microphone is working and everyone can hear me. It's 9.02 and I will now call this meeting to order. I will note that, well, maybe not for today, but Mr. Hansen, I have given, I have approved his remote participation for Mr. Hansen under the board bylaws and 2.2-3708.3B3 of the Code of Virginia.

[00:09:47] because his principal residence is more than 60 miles from the meeting location. So if he is able to join us today, he will join us. Just so that everyone is aware, yearly the Board of Education has a retreat to spend dedicated time to discuss important decisions of the board.

[00:10:07] And today the board will focus on the development of the performance and support network that we have been working on for quite some time within the accreditation system. We're going to discuss the redesign of the state's support framework to support struggling schools and divisions, the year-long work, the board work plan, and we will have a closed session on legal issues.

[00:10:30] So with that, I guess everybody has the agenda in front of them, and we are going to begin with the presentation and discussion on accountability, accreditation, the school support and performance network um and is that you this morning me yeah good we'll tag in a little bit so um if we can go to the next slide um i think that actually the next slide get to the the clicker is

[00:11:05] not working so bear with us yeah the next slide after this one please so i think uh this should hopefully be no surprise to you we know that over the many many months that we've worked with you every time that either Chad or I is presented on this, we started with these guiding principles for the work. You know, really recognizing that the North Star of what we're trying to do with this new school support framework is to hold high expectations for every student, having a really high bar for proficiency and mastery, while also, though, importantly recognizing the importance of growth and progress so that we can recognize the work that schools are doing to get students to

[00:11:43] that PIBAR. The new system is also going to be rooted in transparency and clear, actionable information. It's a real challenge with the current accreditation system is how complicated it is. And part of the reason to do that is to build trust with educators, with parents, with the community. And that, I think, comes to the last point. Stakeholder input is critical in this process. And a good portion of what I'll be talking through today is all the stakeholder input that we have received since you all last met in March.

[00:12:15] I know many of you participated in these listening sessions across the Commonwealth, but we'll talk a little bit about some of the stakeholder input we've received and some guiding questions we'd like to ask you today. So on the next slide, you can see again, sort of the reminder of where we are in this process.

[00:12:32] As Dr. Seibert said, we're at the end of the beginning. We're not at the beginning, but we are nearing the end of the beginning of this process, as Winston Churchill would say. So, you know, you all voted last fall to officially begin the regulatory process around a new school performance system.

[00:12:48] We then had a first round of stakeholder feedback late in the fall, which led to the vote we took in March on the proposed regulation. So now we have the skeleton of the system in place, which we then, over the last several weeks, took back out to the field for another round of stakeholder feedback and listening sessions.

[00:13:09] And now we are here moving forward with putting some of the meat on the bones of that framework because we know we're not just regulating through this process, but we also have to develop a new ESSA state plan since the system is going to be serving both state and federal purposes.

[00:13:27] We'll be working on these asset plan questions throughout the summer, and then ideally, you know, this is all working toward in the fall of 2024, having the sort of preliminary view of the new system and working for it to be fully ready to implement in the 25-26 school year.

[00:13:45] On the next slide, you'll see sort of the purposes of today, which I've already hinted at some of them. We're going to go over the timeline and some of the decisions and actions that have already been made, talk about the feedback we got from all the great stakeholder listening session, and start to talk about what comes next in terms of modeling some of the particular indicators, making some more specific decisions that will help us write that ESSA plan.

[00:14:10] So Chad is really going to get into some of the weeds around the mastery index and around chronic absenteeism and waiting in a deeper way than we have before. So that's a little bit of a preview of what's in the second half of the presentation, and we're going to be with you for a while. And we're really happy that we have you first thing in the morning because we know that these are complicated questions that we hope we're going to have some really great conversation and discussion.

[00:14:33] So if you move forward to the next slide, and just the one after that, I think shows kind of what we've already decided and voted on last March or last month in March. So this is kind of the schematic of what the new system would look like. On the left side, we have one school performance and support framework that meets both state and federal purposes, instead of the two systems we have right now with two lists of schools that need support, that are somewhat different, two different processes for supporting those schools.

[00:15:07] The basis of that school performance framework for elementary and middle schools is those three buckets of growth, readiness, and mastery. And for high schools, it's graduation, readiness, and mastery. That information is then combined together. It's no longer one measure. It's determinative, but we're weighing each of those three buckets to put schools into a performance category, as well as to identify schools that need support, either because they have a student group that is struggling or because the whole school is low performing and needs more comprehensive support.

[00:15:38] And that is all then braided with federal resources as well as with resources and support teams from the Office of School Quality. On the right side, there is still accreditation, but this is now really focused on inputs and compliance with all of the components of the standards of accreditation.

[00:15:54] Not just school performance, but also school safety, technology, staffing, graduation requirements, schools will go through the process of, you know, showing that they have met those standards and then they will be fully accredited. And if they, you know, need some additional support to be conditionally accredited or in some cases accreditation denied. So that is solely to meet the statutory obligations and really focus on operational compliance in a way that the current system is trying to do both compliance and accountability and maybe not doing either particularly well. On the next slide, going a little bit deeper into some of the regulatory actions you've made. Again, sort of, I think this is reflected in the last slide about we voted on

[00:16:34] the categories, achievement or mastery, growth and readiness, as well as graduation and high school. We talked about using expected growth as opposed to formative growth. We talked about weighting for categories, which we'll go into on some of the next slide and just sort of remind you of what those weighting categories are here. You can see for elementary schools, 65% mastery, and that mastery weight gets a little bit lower as you move up into this middle school and high school where you needed to have more growth in the high school side for readiness being 35 percent because it's really important at high school that students are ready for what comes next while readiness at the

[00:17:14] elementary level is only 10 percent. So you sort of see the shifting of the weighting as the school configuration and the grade levels change. If you can go back to the slide before this, we also decided to have four performance categories for the support and performance framework. Again, this is for reporting purposes. It's not the accreditation categories, but there would be at least four summative categories. And we also talked a lot about the value of grading the federal and state systems together so that we can really leverage all of the school support

[00:17:46] resources more effectively. So moving through now, several slides ahead we can get to, want to talk a little bit about what we heard from stakeholders. So we went out. And really when I say we, I didn't go to all of them. I should recognize the staff at the department who went to all of these sessions in each of the eight superintendents regions. I went to three or four. We invited board members. We also had a lot of

local superintendents, teachers, assessment directors, parents, community members. It was a really wide swath of folks who showed up where we walked through the new

[00:18:25] system, and we asked them some particular questions about certain components of the system in anticipating this meeting and the things that we wanted to bring to you. In addition, so we had sort of 211 attendees at those sessions, but there were also virtual sessions that the VDOE held with particular groups, so the School Boards Association, the Principals Associations for high schools, middle schools, and elementary schools, the PTA, school superintendents, and And that was an additional way to get feedback from those particular groups.

[00:18:58] Some of those folks also showed up at the listening sessions as well, but they were sort of an additional way to be sure we're working from those groups. Dr. Toons? Yeah, I just want to flag that we have not yet met with VSBA. That means next week. So, yeah, just as clarified.

[00:19:14] Thank you. So, these are still ongoing. We also, I think, recognize that we are presenting a lot of information to folks at these listening sessions. So, in addition to getting information from them live in the room and taking copious notes, we also had a QR code where folks could submit written comments after the fact that they had a great idea driving home or heard from a colleague and they wanted to share that, they were also able to submit those comments.

[00:19:41] and that's where you see at the bottom here that we've gotten a sort of 170 comments roughly so far through that electronic process and some of these comments are directly sort of building on themes of the listening sessions others are different comments that are related to the system but you know I think we wanted to sort of on the next several slides present some of the biggest themes that we heard so if you go to the next slide you'll see sort of starting to dig into some of these feedback. I think we heard loud and clear the appreciation that we were providing multiple ways to provide feedback. I think again, you know, this system is complicated.

[00:20:19] So I think having that additional QR code, that electronic submission was really helpful, as well as, you know, just recognizing it was important to get out across the state, not just have one listing session in Richmond and call it a day, but to really go to all the communities. You know, we also saw a lot of participants actually attending multiple sessions And that's sort of been deep into their feedback over time once they heard it a second time they sort of something might have clicked that didn't click the first time around.

[00:20:46] And they do want to continue to be engaged in this process as we develop sort of the plan and further details of the support framework. So I think we should be thinking through in the coming months how we continue to reach out to stakeholders and keep them updated on the decisions that have been made.

[00:21:02] and i think one of the pieces that we heard probably the loudest from and i think for the board members who attended you probably also heard this loud and clear is that there is a real strong desire from all stakeholders to have those summative descriptive categories really be narrative and tell a story so to not just be sort of um a number or a letter grade you know we would say i think and dr kuhn did a very good job of saying this is not going to be an a through f system we repeat that three to five or maybe even more times each session but we also heard i think really loud support from stakeholders that that is the kind of system they would prefer is one

[00:21:41] that is really describing the support needs of the school in more descriptive terms and they really wanted to be sure that this whole system um holistically was representing the hard work and successes of educators and schools but also clearly explaining the support that schools needed so what are the challenges and opportunities for growth but what are also the strengths and successes and to highlight both on the next slide we'll get a little bit into some of the feedback we heard on the mastery index component in particular that was something that we spent um several slides on and sort of a dedicated portion of each session talking about in general stakeholders were very supportive

[00:22:20] of the mastery index and liked the fact that we were recognizing every student who sat for an assessment and sort of showing that progress of a student who is getting a below basic or a basic is also getting some credit while those students who are proficient or advanced are getting the most they really liked that concept um the majority of feedback that we got because we were really digging in on you know how do you weight these different performance levels and there was definitely a strong preference to kind of having equal increments of weighting so that between each one you know you weren't jumping from if you go from below basic to basic it's just point one

[00:22:55] increase but let me go to basic to proficient it's point five they really like to sort of equal increments um in general there were a few who didn't but i think the one sort of caveat to that too is that we did get some comments about some concerns that the performance of sort of those high achieving students might mask the performance of the lower achieving students so just wanting to be sure that as we're setting the weights we're doing so in a way that doesn't put so so high a weight that it might sort of mask those students who might be at a low basic level we also heard

[00:23:31] with regard to the master index about participation rates and how students who did not take the assessment for whatever reason would be counted as zero as a reminder this is part of the trade-off that we make of having one federal system that and state system is that the federal government the federal rules do require non-participants to be counted as zero um but we did hear some comments against that you know just in concerns because it's different from the current practice and they would prefer for um those students to not be included at all um we also heard um some particular

[00:24:07] comments on the mastery index just to be sure that it included science that you know i think folks we We were talking a lot about reading and math, but science is included too, right? And also wanting to be sure that, you know, we were thinking about having more similar categories for all assessments.

[00:24:24] This is really a question for the assessment team as they develop, but right now you might remember that the high school assessment and the science assessment only have three performance levels, but those three through eight assessments have four. So, you know, I think they were sort of saying in the future, it might be nice if the science assessment and the end of course assessment also had four achievement levels right now for those assessments there's only one performance level below the proficient level instead of two like with three to eight assessments so that's something that they were sort of interested in the future but as we were saying we got some comments that were related maybe to assessment

[00:25:02] or to other topics that was one of them um on the next slide another area that we really dove into with um can you move to the next slide please thanks um is how to measure growth in elementary schools there's I would say broad support everyone was very excited for having growth be a standalone measure and you know no questions about fourth and fifth grade growth but we really wanted to dive in

around measuring growth in the earlier grades we got some acknowledgement from stakeholders you know generally it's really important for all students to be growing you know they're including

[00:25:38] in the early grades, but I think also a recognition that how to measure growth in third grade is complicated and that we might not currently have the measures in place that would enable Virginia to do that. In particular, you know, we talked about the vows and there was, you know, recognition that like that's a really interesting, you know, it's an important measure, but it wasn't developed to be used in an accountability system. It was developed to be a screener. We're not giving it all students every year we're not doing it with the same secure environment that we do with other assessments and we're not sure we want to use vowels in a more high stakes way so i think there

[00:26:18] was a lot of push and pull here around we're really interested in and we like the idea and concept of measuring third grade growth but we also recognize that our current measures may not allow us to do that and we don't want to increase high stakes assessments for our youngest learners um so i think it was kind of a mixed bag here it's like we wish there was an easier way to do this but we're not you know i think that was sort of the overall feedback what we got i think not full consensus around here but i think it's something that you know if um in chat i think we'll go into this a little bit more in his uh portion you know thinking about how we might

[00:26:57] be able to work toward this in the future but um i think we had a lot of varied views on third grade group on the next slide we talked a lot about readiness at all grade levels um you know sort of had a particular conversation about elementary readiness middle readiness and high school readiness and of course chronic absenteeism bridges across all three of those we got very strong feedback to weight chronic absenteeism lower than other measures um within the readiness bucket i think a lot of the concerns that we heard were just it's hard for us to control this we feel

[00:27:32] like this outside of the school's control so just we recognize that it is going to be included but please don't wait it as much as the other measures and that was at um all the grade spans um we also i think asked particularly in the context of elementary and as you'll see on the next side middle schools about the concept of a performance task to also measure readiness potentially around the five c's um so sort of to try and measure that readiness for middle school readiness for high school. And we got a lot of positive feedback on the concept of a performance test. I think

[00:28:08] there were questions about what this would look like in implementation, particularly if this was a fifth grade assessment, as fifth graders also have the IRW, the Integrated Reading and Writing Assessment. So again, trying to be sure that we're not overburdening a particular grade with assessments. So would this drop to fourth grade if the school didn't have a fifth grade? You sort started to get into those implementation questions of what this would look like. But I think the idea of some sort of performance task was appealing. I think stakeholders would just want to know what does this mean? How do we do this in a way that fits into the school day, is going to be rigorous

[00:28:47] and valid for accountability systems? But I think there was a lot of interest in pursuing or thinking about it more in the future. On the next slide, I think continuing to dig into the performance task as well as some other measures for how we could measure readiness in middle schools in particular. One of the comments that we got probably the most frequently or one of the topics that was hitting on the most comments was the idea that was in the regulation and we talked about last week or last week, seems like last week, a few weeks ago about including advanced coursework.

[00:29:23] And I think the comment that we got was generally more supportive of advanced math, some concerns with advanced coursework and other subjects. In part, this was coming a lot from maybe our more rural schools or schools that have a struggle.

[00:29:40] They worry about the staffing implications of this. They're already struggling to get these teachers in their high schools. And now we're thinking, you know, how do we get them in our middle school and just wanting to be sure that this wasn't going to create sort of an equity issue on them or make it harder for them to sort of actually also teach, you know, the eighth grade math content and these advanced coursework.

[00:30:03] There were some interest in foreign language from a few commenters. I would just say, you know, recognizing we don't have right now a high school assessment of foreign language, so that would be more of a participation measure, you know, participating in foreign language in middle school, as opposed to some of the things we were talking about with math, where we would be looking at those SOL scores and the end of course assessment.

[00:30:27] So I think that this was one where I feel like we got some mixed feedback, I would say, and just some concerns, particularly from those smaller schools or more rural districts and divisions. We did also, and this was sort of a pivot that was made in the middle of the listening sessions to really also then talk about performance tasks with middle school as a measure of readiness, in part because of a comment that was made one of the listening sessions about the career planning.

[00:30:57] that occurs in the middle grades and could that be a performance task and so I think the department said that's a really good idea let's start talking about this and testing it with with other folks and there was a really I think strong positive feedback to that idea I think recognizing that students are doing these career plans and this could be a way to really make them meaningful and have recognized that like that to me is readiness for high school is you know what are you thinking about on that career plan. Again, sort of knowing that there are going to be these implementation questions of what that looks like. In practice, again, it's going to feel like another high-stakes

[00:31:35] test in eighth grade. Those sort of same comments that we heard in the elementary grades also apply to the middle grades. But I think there was a strong interest of that. And also sort of recognizing CTE electives or service learning was important. So that's sort of the general feedback we got on some of the middle school readiness components. On the next slide, we talk about the readiness we got specific for high school readiness, that college career military civic readiness measure. We got a lot of positive feedback, again, about the inclusion of readiness and wanting it to

[00:32:10] be inclusive of many different post-secondary pathways and options. So, wanting to be sure that we include work-based learning in a measurable way, as well as recognizing dual and concurrent enrollment, not just AP and IB, but sort of all of those early post-secondary coursework experiences.

[00:32:30] A lot of interest in ways to include civics readiness, particularly, again, through community service or some sort of civics experience was typically those comments. So, they thought that that would be the best way to measure civics engagement. We also asked specifically about graduation rate. Again, the stakeholders recognize that blending this system with the federal requirements means we have to use the federal four-year graduation rate, but they also, I think, generally across the board, advocated for continuing to also include something like the graduation and completion index to recognize students that are earning other types of diplomas,

[00:33:08] graduating in multiple, you know, more than four years, maybe getting a GED or certificate completion. So that was an area where I think there was more consensus than some of the other topics we've talked about. And then finally, on the final slide that summarizes some of the stakeholder feedback, I think, again, reiterating on the idea of sort of school performance identification, strong consensus to not use any sort of A through F grading scale, and much sort of more positive feedback toward the idea of descriptive categories. We had included in the slides for these listening sessions, some examples from other states, and they really liked in many

[00:33:48] sessions the main language, where they called schools exemplar, meeting, developing, emerging, so they would sometimes riff off of that language and come up with their own categories, but I think they liked the way that that main was framing those categories. We also heard in some sessions but not others the idea of using language similar to teacher evaluation, and some stakeholders liked sort of colors and numbers, but that wasn't sort of across the board. Other folks were saying, you know, we prefer not to use colors, not to use numbers. So that was one where there was more

[00:34:21] mixed feedback. But I think general theme is, you know, really strong emphasis on how these summative categories can, again, like tell the story of where the school is doing well, tell the story of where there might be challenges, and talk about the supports that each school is receiving if they were in that getting that comprehensive support or if they were you know maybe perhaps getting targeted support for a particular group of students and we heard just over and over again you know how important the communication side of this will be both in the work that you all are continuing to do in developing the system and getting feedback from stakeholders but you know as these decisions are being made also then

[00:35:00] communicating it to parents the community teachers and really being sure that you know this system is transparent and clear to them. And we also got a few comments, particularly around, you know, if schools are identified for support, ensuring that the support that they're getting from the Office of School Quality, you know, is deep and meaningful and, you know, going to be sufficient to help those schools improve. So I think with that, that is the summary of the feedback that we've gotten. Like I said, I think that QR code is still live. There's still the meeting next week

[00:35:36] with the SBA and others. So this is, of course, isn't the sum total of all the comments that we might receive, but I think is a good indication of the type of feedback that we've gotten so far. Madam President? Comments, questions here? Ms. Holton? Hi. Good morning. Thank you, Ms. Islap, for that summary. I am seeing just now that there are a bunch of public comments that we've received in the board portal about accountability and accreditation, including

[00:36:13] including a letter from all the Region 1 divisions working together and a number of other divisions weighing in with similar comments, and there's a reference to a comment from something from VAST that I'm not sure whether they're referring to something recent or what we saw last month, but my question is, have you incorporated that source of feedback into what you've described, or is that something we should be looking at separately?

[00:36:44] Well, I mean, I think that at this point, feedback that we're receiving is feedback that we're all taking into account as we move forward. So I don't expect Anne and Chad to be specifically looking at the public feedback that we've gotten.

[00:37:04] Yeah, I'm not saying they should or shouldn't. I'm just asking whether they did so that we know if you did not incorporate them, we need to be looking at that separately. So you received a slide deck last

week that incorporated, and you heard the disclaimer at the bottom of that slide that that was before April 15th.

[00:37:22] As talked about in the board packets that were released, everything is through April 19th. So anything that's dated after April 19th is not included in the aggregate in the slides. But anything that's, there are some items that would.

[00:37:39] Anything dated in the public comment after April 19th is not included in the deck. and anything before april 19th is included in the day in the feedback you all have analyzed or is it separate because it's coming through the separate the department summarized the data and the department included every piece of public comment dated april 19th or prior thank you that helps me understand thank you yes yeah we knew we needed to get the materials as soon as possible but also recognizing that some of these listing sessions were occurring you know last week and that there

[00:38:15] of meetings, you know, we didn't want to say, well, not meet, you know, it's important to meet with folks. And I think that will be continuing to occur. So I think in future meetings as well, we also know that the regulations are going to be officially published in the Virginia Register. So we know we're going to be continuing to get public comment. So in particular, this comment from divisions, from a wide group of divisions, a lot of it seems to be dated April 19th. So I would just encourage my fellow board members to take that into consideration. There's one from

[00:38:48] the Region 1 Chief Academic Officers that seems to be a model that a number of other divisions have shared as well, but that's a lengthy, thoughtful set of comments. Dr. Harris? I will just mention you have 211 pieces of public comment that individuals submitted, So there are 211 pieces of comment that has been aggregated into the slide deck and the information.

[00:39:28] Mr. Rotherham? I have a couple of questions. So on slide 12, you talked about participation rate. What was, I mean, historically, this has been a problem. I mean, like a lot of us when we first got into this work, it was always by, you know, by coincidence, the kids who weren't going to do well on the test got a field trip on the day that the tests were being given um we you know we try to change that by having participation requirements and so forth um you know the the perverse incentive there is obvious um what was all like what kind of ideas

[00:40:05] did people come up with uh when people were saying they want participation what kind of ideas they come up with is like alternatives or ways to ensure that kids are being assessed across and And again, we are assessing, particularly at the high school level, across a bunch of different things. And so I guess my first question is, what stuff was raised as ways, as workarounds here, excuse me, in the hearings?

[00:40:25] And then second, just your expertise and Mr. Alderman, like what other best practices should we be thinking about if we're not going to have just a requirement for participation rates? So I don't think there were really many alternatives raised, frankly. It was, I think, just we would like these students to be completely discounted from the mastery index.

[00:40:46] They should not be in the numerator. They should not be in the denominator. They should just be excluded. I think there was an understanding that participation rates are reported separately. So, you know, they would still, no one was saying we shouldn't report participation rates just for transparency's sake.

[00:41:02] But for the mastery index, they should just be excluded. And I don't think there were really any alternatives, you know, offered around, and here's how we would hold schools accountable for that reported rate either. It was more just, you know, these are parents who are, you know, many cases choosing not to accept their kids, or a student is sick, like, it was sort of, we just won't include them.

[00:41:28] And I think that best practices, you're speaking to the second part of your question, is what we proposed here, I would say, is actually incorporating participation rate for the states that have indexes, like Virginia is moving toward, this is how they include non-participants.

[00:41:48] And it does create an incentive to recognize that kids are going to be sick. There's always going to be some kids who, you know, for whatever reason, are not going to be there on assessment day. But that's why it's 95 percent participation. It's not 100 percent. It's 95 percent.

[00:42:06] And so this is how states that have indices have accomplished it. I do think we heard from a couple of people that the denominator, I'm sorry, should be a 95 percent. So if you're doing your mastery index and the federal expectation is 95%, we heard a couple of comments that then the denominator should be 95%.

[00:42:29] Dr. Siebert? I think one of the things I heard is sidebar conversations, especially at the listening session I attended and some other colleagues, is that not all non-participation is the same. In Compton, Walter, Virginia, a parent can opt their child out of SOL tests simply because they don't want their child to deal with it, the stress, they just don't agree with it, whatever.

[00:42:48] So, you know, parents choosing to exercise a family's opt out and that that kind of runs hot and cold. That could be like a poolside conversation in the summer. And then that next year, a lot of families do it. You know, so that parental opt out provision, we think should count differently than just non-participants.

[00:43:06] Participation absolutely is essential. It should be highlighted. It could be its own little box. It could be color coded, you know, a bold, whatever you want to do. But there's a difference between people opting out of the families exercising their right to opt out versus, you know, again, children who are genuinely ill and any other things.

[00:43:26] So I agree, you know, Ms. Rotherham, we certainly don't want to create any any perverse incentives, but we also need to recognize that schools don't have full authority of compelling people to take the test. Yes, certainly. I mean, I assume we're not changing anything around our provisions with if a kid's sick, there's makeup options and so forth.

[00:43:46] We're not. So we're talking here about either kids who are chronically not there or whose parents are electing not to have them assessed. There's obviously, and you alluded to it, Dr. Siebert, there's a moral hazard there as well that we need to be conscious of.

[00:44:03] Madam President. So, Ms. Halton. I do see the letter from the chief academic officers in region one does have a suggestion about participation rates, but I frankly don't understand it. And Dr. Coombs, I would be curious whether did the superintendents have any input on that or the principals?

[00:44:25] Did they have any suggestions? I think what this is suggesting is that it says participation needs to be addressed as a component of the accountability system. So maybe they want the participation rate reported as part of the system and somehow factored in, but I'm not sure what they mean.

[00:44:42] I don't know if you have any clarification. We did meet with the Region 1 Chief Academic Officers separately. They requested one of those additional meetings, and in the conversation, they expressed some of the similar concerns that Dr. Siebert mentioned. And what Anne said about sharing the participation rate, but not necessarily counting it in the accountability component, but given that this is a federal requirement, we talked through that with them.

[00:45:11] And so I think there's a lot of wrestling across the state with what we count and what we share, and that is where the angst has been. The only recommendation that I heard that was clear solution-oriented was putting 95% as the denominator. And that would be allowed under federal law.

[00:45:29] And sharing means that we would somehow post it, which I presume we probably do already somewhere anyway, but post it somehow, but not wait it. Wait it. Is that what that meant? We heard several comments to that effect.

[00:45:45] Thank you. My second question, I have three. My second question on chronic absenteeism. I feel like this board with members appointed across two administrations has been fairly clear on chronic absenteeism and our belief that it is important to hold accountable and it is not like the weather.

[00:46:05] There are actually things you can that you can do about it, even when they're challenging. Did anything new come up? I heard that raise. And again, any new ideas, any new anything we should anything we should be aware of that would cause us to want to reconsider our posture on that?

[00:46:21] So I think that we did hear, and I did not iterate this in the discussion, that the sort of flexibility around chronic absenteeism and, you know, a student who maybe then can make up that time in another way, they appreciated that and think I sort of like, I'd like, would like for that policy to continue as a way I think a division in particular found that very helpful to them in trying to combat chronic absenteeism.

[00:46:45] So I'd say that's probably the most concrete example of sort of a proactive thing that came out of the lifting sessions. And I would, you know, think they also recognize, though, that this will be included. You know, I think they, stakeholders had heard that this board and the prior, you know, other boards have said chronic aptitude was important and knew it was going to be a measure.

[00:47:09] or they just said, you know, could you weight it as low as please possible? Which, you know, and say the weighting in the system is like a signal of what is valued and what is important. And so, you know, weighing the stakeholder feedback, but also recognizing that at the end of the day, the board needs to be putting the weights behind the measures that you feel are reflective of what is most important and balancing that in the conversation through the board.

[00:47:40] I think there was a lot of angst because in our current system, chronic absenteeism currently moves the school out of accredited with conditions and conditions. So there's a general concern. I don't think there's a real concrete understanding of the shifts that the board is looking to make.

[00:47:57] But there's a general concern about chronic absenteeism in general and the focus and the work and the efforts and making sure that's supported. Jeremy and I heard that yesterday at the state superintendent's conference, continuing to make sure supports are there. And we had a lot of conversation about we have to transparently talk about the overall health to provide the supports. But I think there's some angst about moving into accredited with conditions or TSI solely on chronic absenteeism. And I think that's where a lot of the source of concern that we heard and a lot of the feedback we heard is not a true

[00:48:33] deep understanding of the intent of moving into readiness and being a component of readiness. So I think as we continue to talk that, that was what I had heard across the Commonwealth in our sessions. That's a great point. Dr. Sievert?

[00:48:49] Yeah, I would echo that. I think, again, a lot of people are understanding of looking at things with a lens of the way we've done things, and the idea that chronic absenteeism could be the one switch that turned off all the lights is the source of that angst. The other thing, kudos, a lot of feedback has been that, again, just like we talked about minute ago not all non-participants are the same not all absences are the same and really what the department has done uh in this current school year to understand that you can make up time for time that that has actually been appreciated and helpful because that also just from an instructional perspective it decouples with the the learning from the time so if the child misses time they can make up time and the school gets credit for that that whole approach has been very welcome

[00:49:27] this school year and i think first of all looking at the way it used to creates angst but also the The way things are being done now helps mitigate that. So I've not heard that it should not be included. If you understand it should be included, it might also, you know, be a little box off to the side to really lift it up.

[00:49:44] But, you know, the weight is certainly where the concern is. Yeah, my third question. And then actually, I want to flip you over just on this. What other just I just wanted to ask you all when you are professionals, you do this around the country, you what other misconceptions are like, are common about this that we should be as a board aware of and pushing through there does seem both you know based on correspondence we've received things we've heard you know sidebar conversations that we all have with with stakeholders there does seem to be some confusion um and and i think there's you know some understandable reasons for that what are the

[00:50:23] big ones that you all heard that we should be attentive to making sure as alan said people are naturally going to view this through the way we've done it so like what in your i'm asking in your expert opinion not just as sort of virginia experts but as national experts just what are the misconceptions that we should endeavor to to make sure we're clearing up that you're hearing a lot the patterns i think the biggest one is the one that dr king's doctor said we're talking about is this idea of we are so used to in virginia of a single measure determining the outcome that the concept of a multi-measure system a weighted measure you know then sort of guiding

[00:51:00] which schools are getting support, which schools are not in support, it's just really hard to think in. So I think repeating that over and over. I would also say, I don't think the concept of how accreditation is shifting to be about compliance is also setting in either. We hear a lot of people still say, you know, accredited. I'm like, no, no, this is the performance system we're talking about. Accreditation is separate. So that component of we're actually bifurcating these two systems and there's going to be accreditation that serves one purpose and then the support framework that serves a second purpose, I don't think that message needs to continually be raised for sure.

[00:51:39] And then I would say within some of the indicators and measures, I think it helps that we have been starting to measure growth in this new way, but I think we still hear when we're talking about the mastery index, some people defaulting to the combined rate and thinking that, oh, well, how are students that make progress counted in the mastery index?

[00:52:03] And we're like, no, no, no, that's a separate measure. You know, growth is now a separate measure. And we have VBOS, we're going to have, you know, or some form of expected growth. And so I think, again, that's a piece where, you know, for the last several years where folks are so used to the combined rate, they're already asking about how those students are included. And it's just really important to keep reiterating the separation of growth from mastery. Sorry, I'm sorry I'm boring you all with a lot of questions, but I have a bunch. My last one, you heard a bunch of places where people think we're being too rigorous, like the bars being set too high and all that. Where are the places you heard from the field where we're

[00:52:43] setting the bar too low, where we should be pushing? What feedback do we get on places where we're missing the mark and we're not being ambitious enough or demanding enough? What did hear on that um there was probably at least in the session three sessions i attended that was maybe less of a theme i do think there was a recognition around when schools are identified for supports so those schools that are low performing or have a people student group of making sure that the supports are actually meaningful and and rigorous and that it means

[00:53:19] something that we're actually getting something as a school something is different whether that means more resources more money like more help from the state team that was a place i think where you know we wanted to be sure that that was not just a paper pushing exercise but that's something that was actually meaningful and when you help the school get the things that they needed to support their kids i'd say that was one piece for sure and i do think that we heard a lot as well about wanting to recognize students that go above and beyond so i think this came up especially in

[00:53:55] the mastery index conversations around you know i think one of the examples didn't have an equal jump between proficiency and advanced and then you know well we want to really recognize students who are advanced who are free cello that is a really high bar how can we incentivize getting that advanced distinction getting an advanced diploma or you know those sort of post-secondary experiences in the CCCRI. So we did hear that. I think we heard a lot, especially in the educator sessions, about the excitement on the rigorous standards that the board passes, on the excitement

[00:54:31] of the rigor being built into the overall system, and having excitement of meeting those expectations. In particular, when they talked about the middle school advanced coursework, they talked about we want to have rigorous expectations. We're excited that the standards are becoming more rigorous. We're excited about leaning into rigor. I don't think that everybody was connecting the dots between the standards, the assessments, and the accountability in the way that you are asking. I don't think that that conceptual area was there, but there was a lot of excitement about providing rigorous and making sure there was rigor in the system and that we were preparing

[00:55:07] students for the future. I just don't think it was as concrete as what you're asking. thank you um yeah mr robert ham's question i didn't hear i haven't heard people say you know oh the bar is too high the bar is too hello i'm hearing tell us where the bar is going to be and again this is just because people are you know good leaders look around corners people are trying to anticipate the next steps and you know once the system is implemented you know what's going to determine the thresholds and those kinds of things so i haven't heard anything about it being too high or too low just a lot of questions about how we go about that i think that yes there's as

[00:55:45] As Dr. Kuhn said, a lot of interest in solid standards, strong standards, what we do there. And there's also great support for a system that's going to bring clarity. And so there's also support for that. The question mark within, I think, the bar piece for Ms. Rob MCs is there's still a whole lot of angst about the assessments that we use, how old they are, and what we might be able to do better in the future.

[00:56:07] So there's this assessment piece that we know is kind of running on a different track. That kind of, I think, fits in more than where the bar is too high or too low. I do think that one component that we need to really focus on in this conversation is what we have been doing has not worked.

[00:56:27] What we have been doing has kept school divisions in MOU status for decades, for generations, and that is absolutely just uncomprehensible to me.

[00:56:45] I cannot believe that we have not been able to find a way to help the schools and school divisions that perpetually have stayed in this state.

[00:57:01] It absolutely destroys me emotionally to think that kids feel stuck because they are not getting what other students are getting in other school divisions.

[00:57:16] And we're not we're not helping them move in that direction. Let's do it. Let's actually take this opportunity to really re-face this whole game and fix this once and for all for every student in Virginia who deserves the very best education.

[00:57:41] Dr. Gaines? I think to that point, one thing we heard a lot of conversation around when we talked about 93% of our schools accredited before the pandemic and 90% after is we know our system isn't working to identify those students who need needs, those students who need support and really drive in supports. So we were having to layer a lot of additional things on to explain the supports our schools needed. And that's not the intent. Your intent of your performance and support framework is to explain where schools are transparently from your North Star and your guiding principles and understand what supports. And there was a lot of coherence and a lot of

[00:58:17] conversation around our accreditation system doesn't do that right now. It doesn't say what supports our schools really need. And if we look at the needs and the changing needs of schools after post-pandemic, whether it's attendance, whether it's academics, whether the needs are not being represented, so the supports can't be driven directly to the needs, which is the intent of ESSA, which is the intent of an accountability structure. There was a lot of agreement. I know, Dr. Siebert, you and I talked about this yesterday. There's a lot of agreement that we're not getting the information we need to really support schools right now.

[00:59:02] i'm going to pass it over to chad and to do the second half of the presentation all right if you go to slide 19 we're going to start talking about some of some models uh indicators so we're building the system from the ground up uh we're going to start by talking about the mastery index and i've got some uh results to show for you today and then we can talk through them these are deliberative these are uh just things for you to to consider as we give us direction and input as we keep working on the ssa state plan so we modeled out two

[00:59:39] different types of mastery indexes indices model one was standardized increments so every single level from one level to the next has the same level of increase so for 3d math and reading it would be 0.33 for below basic students who reach basic would burn 0.67 points opto-proficient would be one and

any student scoring in advance would be 1.33 so uh we're going to talk a little bit about elementary and middle school first uh i will say just so you know

[01:00:14] that i did the same thing for high schools so for high schools the weights would be 0.5 0.1 and 1.5 those as ann mentioned those only have the three performance levels at this point in time so that's i'm carrying through the same standardized increments in that system as well model two is more of an emphasis on the proficiency bar so again proficiency has a weight of one students who are at below basic would earn 0.2 at below basic would get 0.5 and advanced has a slightly smaller bonus of 1.2 so that's how the indices are constructed and i'm going to show you some

[01:00:53] data of what the results would look like across virginia schools if you go to the next slide we're having a problem with the visuals here we can't see the slides and i think there's lots of conversation to be had so this speaker right here we can't see any of the information on the slide and i think people want to have conversations yeah uh so if you want to put to slide 19 you want to talk about the for this the indices were you mentioning the data or the

[01:01:31] weights for it in particular we can't we can't see like the bottom of it because this is in the way for these people why don't we just take like a four minute break so we can we just can't see the actual slides to be able to engage virtually so if we can see one of them that would be really

[01:01:52] helpful um dr sievert had something he wanted to say chad before we we left that that part of the

[01:08:55] the presentation and jumped into yours so if um we could just let him have a moment please i just want to share a couple more positive things that um that i just wanted to lift up there we're in some of and slides there was definitely support for narrative approach there was a the fact that the five c's were being elevated to talk about the five c's in terms of readiness that was also really really appreciate it because a lot of work has been on the five C's and over the past many years.

[01:09:19] So that was really good. You know, the chance of looking at the seventh grade academic plan portfolio as a tool was also very positive. But the other thing, you know, back to the VALS conversation, formerly PALS, that people want that to remain a formative and engaging tool for teachers and their students and have those conversations. And so there's definitely an interest looking at growth in grades up through grade three, but that the VAL system wouldn't want to become this onerous, you know, secure kind of environment, which should be sort of a formative

[01:09:55] thing. So if there's a way to knit that together, that would be swell. But the other big thing for to get that was in terms of the readiness piece or the elementary indicator was really highlighting the third grade reading, whether that, you know, not necessarily in the masterpiece, maybe it's its own box. But third-grade reading is a pretty well-known, looked-at standard across divisions as an indicator. And so kind of highlighting third-grade reading in some way would be appreciated. That also then helps honor the work that's done K-2 and getting children ready to be

[01:10:29] successful. Thank you, Madam President. All right. Thank you, Dr. Stebier. So we're going to talk through the mastery indices potential weights i've got some uh representative data to show you we're not taking any votes today it's more just getting your direction and input on what you see uh things that jump out to you what you like what you don't like uh so like i said these are representative um on the left is

what we call the sort of model one the standardized increments and they go up by the same amount across all the different performance bands for uh where where the

[01:11:08] assessments have four performance levels they would go up from 0.33 up to 1.33 for advanced where they do not either high school or science they would in this model would only go from 0.51 to 1.5 the opposite model is what we call the proficiency emphasis which puts a greater jump if you will, on the proficiency bar from 0.2 for below basic, 0.5 for basic, 1 for proficient up to 1.2 for advanced. So less of a weight for advanced in that particular model. So I'm going to show you

[01:11:47] some results and then please stop me if there's things that jump out to you if you have any questions. Again, model one is the standardized increments on the left. The big thing to note there is that there are two big things. One is there are some schools at the far right side, which are getting some higher scores from the advanced. They're also a bigger group in the middle, sort of in that high middle range, whereas the proficiency emphasis is a little more spread out. It doesn't have the same number of schools at the far end. But I wouldn't take too much out

[01:12:24] this histogram the way that i would look at it is here is a comparison of the percentile rank of schools that are ranked on the equal weighted index versus the rank on the weighted index so this would be essentially giving them a score and then putting them from zero to 100 and the scores are very very similar the schools there's not like an example of a school that is very low in one and all of a sudden gets really high in the other in here. So there is the most extreme

[01:12:59] example I pulled out is in red of two schools that are fairly similar on proficiency rates, and they're getting the same on the equal weighted index, but they're getting, sorry, on the proficiency weighted index, but they're getting a slightly different weights on the equal weighted index. And it's because of that proficiency, sorry, because of the advanced level there.

[01:13:25] So those two schools, the school on the left actually has a higher proficiency rate than the school on the right, which has a higher advanced rate. And so it's getting higher score on the equal weighted index. Madam President, this is really helpful, Chad. First, can I understand And this is based on you're using our actual schools and test data from?

[01:13:54] Yeah, this is spring 23 data, and it's three through five reading and math scores. Okay, so it's just elementary school. This is just elementary, yes. Okay, and using the actual data on three through five reading and math scores.

[01:14:13] Yes. But help me understand this. compare this chart to the one on the slide before it. So I understand this chart basically tells me, well, it doesn't really matter that much whether we use the left-hand model or the right-hand model, the standardized increments, or remember what you call the other, because you're going to get basically the same results. But then if you go back to the prior slide, that looks to me like you're getting pretty different results, because that one you're getting on the standardized increment you're getting more in the three middle categories and less in the and also i'm seeing

[01:14:50] i'm confused because the one on the left has six categories and the one on the right has five categories or there was just nobody in the top category yeah they have the same number of categories the this is sort of their raw points that they would get and this looks at how they score in the distribution. So comparison to all other schools, what you can see in this one is that the standardized increments are

getting slightly higher numbers, partly because the weights are higher, whereas on the right, they get lower raw scores. But in terms of percentile rank

[01:15:28] of how schools fall in the distribution, they're quite similar. So again, I'm not, I apologize, I'm not fully understanding here, but I'm not sure I need to fully understand if the point of this slide is, at least for elementary schools, whether we use the standardized increment or the proficiency emphasis won't make much difference in how the schools are rated on the mastery index.

[01:15:56] Yeah, I mean, that is one conclusion. So the correlation across these two measures is 0.99. It's very high. There are some differences, as I said, like if you look at those two red schools that I've highlighted in red, there are some differences. It does give some extra credit for the higher advanced, but the two models essentially agree on 46 out of 48 of the bottom 5% schools.

[01:16:20] That's just a random cutoff that I chose aligned to the federal identification system. So there are some schools that get a bump from the equal weighted version, more credit for the advanced scores. You'll see this. I'm going to go through a similar exercise for the high schools and you'll see it in high school.

[01:16:36] It's a little bit more of a bump there. But the other thing I should note is that compared to compared both of these indices to a straight proficiency model there, They shrink the variance across schools. So these shrink or the straight proficiency, which one shrinks?

[01:16:51] The indices shrink the variance. So in the proficiency, the one school might have 13% up to some in the 90s. So there's a big difference. Whereas in the mastery index, that's much closer together.

[01:17:08] So the variance, the distribution across them is shrunk. So two more questions, if I may. Some schools get a bump from the system that gives more weight for advanced scores. How would you characterize those schools?

[01:17:24] What schools are getting that bump? Yeah, it's the school in the right in red, which actually has a lower proficiency rate than the school on the left that's highlighted in red.

[01:17:41] But in the equal weighted index, it's actually higher. And so that's where the sort of extremes are. They look similar on one measure, but they look different on another measure. That's the most extreme example on this particular comparison. Again, it's not a super extreme comparison, as you can see.

[01:17:57] They're still fairly close together, but that's showing the outliers. And can you tell us anything else about those schools or about the data for those schools that would help us understand what schools it's impacting? I didn't look at, again, this is more representative, so I didn't want to say too much about the particular schools.

[01:18:18] The one thing I can say is that the advanced rates for the one on the right is like an outlier compared to the other schools around similar proficiency levels. So they must have a distribution of students in that school where they have a disproportionately high number of students scoring at advanced level.

[01:18:38] And then can you go back two more slides to the chart with that? Yeah. That one. Yeah. Yeah. So you've given us two options here, but am I right that we really have many options? Yes. So we could wait. I mean, we could do 1.2 for advanced and 0.67 for basic, for instance.

[01:19:00] We could we could do some combination of what's on the left chart and what's on the right chart. Absolutely. Yeah. So these are just trying to give you two. So, Chad, these are the two. This is what we asked you guys to help us with to bring these. this is based on feedback.

[01:19:16] - Yes, so the standardized measure, standardized increments was one of the more popular things that we heard from the stakeholder feedback was that they liked a standardized increments. The one thing I will say also for the field, I think they want simplicity. So I wouldn't mess around too much with 0.78 or anything that's too fancy.

[01:19:36] And I think that's also, you can see in the data is that they're quite similar. - And I do think that we have to keep in mind the very forefront of our minds the entire time that we're working on this is why we did this in the first place not to make it even more cumbersome and lack transparency more than what we already have so if if the field is telling us that it's going to be too confusing you know with with some of these pieces that chad's giving us i think we have to be responsive to that we want for everyone to be able to understand this system.

[01:20:12] I mean, I envision even students understanding what this means to their school and how these things have come together to talk about what their school looks like. Mr. Rotherham and then Ms. Ashton.

[01:20:32] I too, President Greasy, look forward to visiting schools and listening to students debate this in the cafeteria area and in the hallways um and on the playing fields um um so this is really helpful I think you're the point you're making on the differences aren't that substantial I would it is really important I and I agree on simplicity I would urge us generally speaking how these processes go and I want to build on President Creasy's comments like the previous process that we are are reforming

[01:21:07] away from was based on how do we make things look good and we can go through all the various gyrations over the years to accomplish that we don't want to then make a similar mistake which is to be like which distribution do we like more what one look which one looks it should have face validity if you showed us a model it had every school in the commonwealth failing we would say okay that's obviously not the case and if it had every school at 90 we would you know 90 of them said they're doing fine we would say that's not the case that's part of the reason that we're here um so i think and this goes miss holton said it doesn't matter that much i do think it actually

[01:21:46] matters because we're essentially making some value judgments on how do we value advanced relative to below basic are we concerned that advanced could mask a lot of kids at below basic and i'd urge us to think about that as a board with that that the values approach because these numbers will change presumably we're going to make a bunch of other changes that we're talking about so schools are going to do better so the histogram is not going to be a fixed thing going forward um and so we approach it from that point of view of like what are the values that we want to have embedded in this that was part of the conversation we had about what what assessments we were going to use the various measures of high school how are we going to think about growth

[01:22:23] versus proficiency to elementary i think we're at another point where we should be thinking about this in terms of in terms of like what are the values we want reflected in it and then kind of let the chips fall where they may rather than come at it from like what do what do we think is like a good good looking curve that's not uh that's not what that's not what we're going for here madam president sorry thanks yeah i i want to echo the same point and i i really wanted to have clarity on the feedback that you're seeking here is it a preference one way or the other

[01:22:57] uh i think in general when i look at both of the two charts those that is the information i think we the public the board needs to say like which schools are doing really well how can we go learn from them how do we figure out what they're doing versus what other schools are doing like to me that's the point of this is to have good information to say there are some schools that are making progress with similar kids similar students similar resources how do we learn from that and then if i'm a school i'm saying okay what are those similar schools how do i call

[01:23:32] my my peers and my friends and say like what are you doing that is allowing for um the progress for students so from from my perspective i i do appreciate the the the bump around advance i had i had questions around like well does that does demographics determine or uh address determine the advances or a connection there and it does it unfairly um skew towards more fluent more

[01:24:06] resource communities and so i wouldn't want this system to uh to do that whereas and i also appreciate the simplicity of the proficiency emphasis where it's just very straight it's um it feels clear to me the 0.634 has me thinking schools running models and you know messing it up which then just causes more confusion but um i think more importantly i want to know what is the input that we are providing related to this that would be helpful in terms of next steps

[01:24:47] So, two comments. The first is, I just think this is really technical and hard. And therefore, I'm interested in you all's expert recommendation and also telling us what are other states that seem to have well-working mastery indices doing. Are they more like the left or more like the right? And are the weightings similar to these or are they different?

[01:25:11] So that's one question. And then the other was just to follow up on Ms. Ashton's very thoughtful comment. How do we tell whether this is skewing towards more resource communities? Is there data we can look at? And, you know, I've been asking for modeling data that would compare these outcomes like what you've done in the subsequent slide, looking at schools based on the percentage of free and reduced lunch quintiles or quartiles.

[01:25:45] So that's two in one.

[01:25:56] I'll say one thing, which is that compared to other states, more states are more in the proficiency emphasis model, I would say. They have they give a small bonus for advanced, but not as big as what I've modeled here for the standardized.

[01:26:13] There is one state that has pretty high on the advanced rating. And I know that like once Virginia is preparing the plan, the state plan to the U.S. Ed, they'll want to know how that is playing out and whether we've considered things like whether it's masking.

[01:26:30] So that would be something that we would continually have a conversation if we would push higher on the advanced weight. I agree with Chad that most states are doing the proficiency emphasis. And I also agree with Mr. Rotherham that this is a values-based judgment as well.

[01:26:51] I'll put my cards on the table. Personally, I like the mastery index that we had in the last set of slides, and I'll explain why. I think that it takes more effort to get a child who is basic up below basic to the basic level.

[01:27:07] So if you'll recall in this first other example we had, it was 1.0 proficient, and then you went down 0.25 was the very below basic, but then you were 0.75 at the basic. So in other words, you got twice

the credit for moving a child from the very bottom to the basic, and then a little less credit for going basic to proficient, and even less credit going proficient to advance.

[01:27:34] Because that's what we're trying to do, right? we're trying to incentivize those kids at the bottom, moving them up the chain. And testing wise, lots of times, unfortunately, we reach a ceiling effect on these tests. So we can't measure the ones that go from proficient to advanced, as well as we can measure the kids that go from below basic to basic. There's been plenty of studies that show that these tests do a better job identifying the kids who are at the bottom and moving them up than at the top and moving them higher because of these ceiling effects. So I would just advocate, honestly, I get that some people want these equal, you know, things. But I think we're going to have a harder time measuring

[01:28:14] the top of the spectrum. And I think that values based, we should actually give schools more credit for moving the kids from the bottom up the ladder. Thank you, Madam President. I believe in moving forward. All of these indexes and the weights and formulas and ideas and concepts, every time a concept comes up, it seems as though there's a counter concept. So if a presentation is put forward and you say, this is the direction we want to go, then the question is asked, well, tell me more about it. Tell me more about this school and that school and this demographics,

[01:28:51] that demographics, whether or not one school has more wealth than the other, and we get nothing done. So if we have a vision, let's move in that direction. No one knows the exact, there's not one way of doing it. If it were, we'd be doing it. But it seems as though as we're trying to move forward, there's opposition and give all these different ideas to slow the process down. I think we have a good foundation. I think we should move in the direction that we're moving. We have experts here that's given his ideas. But if we constantly, with every point, make a counterpoint, we're going

[01:29:29] be here all day doing nothing. My view is through education, it is a process and you learn every year. So I would just like to just keep moving forward with where we're at. And Ms. Holton, I know you have some great ideas and it appears as though you're asking, you're muddying the water a little bit with each concept. I support the concept that's being presented and I just think have to move and then time will tell whether or not this is the proper way and what we did was

[01:30:08] right thank you madam president yeah just so um i'd say the high school things so the waiting for the high school on the standardized increments had the highest bonus for the advanced the one i modeled here and you can see it a little bit more in the dispersion of schools so again this is the high school data this is very similar to the elementary data the two schools that i've highlighted are very similar on the um equal weighted index the proficiency weighted index

[01:30:46] i'm sorry i keep misspeaking here uh though a school on the left actually had a higher proficiency rate whereas a school on the right had a much higher advanced rate and so it it scores it looks a lot better on the equal weighted index so i'll just um put that out there of it's a similar type of story but it's more exaggerated because of the advanced story at the high school level if i can just ask dr northern a clarifying question so your the proposal you were making for the elementary was 0.25 below basic 0.75 basic one at proficient and what were you recommending

[01:31:26] for the uh advanced advanced 1.25 so you'd get a quarter between proficient and advanced but you'd you'd get a half, 0.50, if you moved them from below basic to basic. Okay. And then did you have a comparable recommendation for high school? And I don't know where middle school fits in. Yeah. In my

mind, I didn't see a compelling rationale for changing them at grade levels, but I could... So you would do the same at all?

[01:31:57] Well, that would have the simplicity effect. Right. Yeah. The main reason is there's just different performance bands. There's only three performance bands at the high school and for science and so that's why i need something else gotcha why is that is that it's a dr can yeah i'm going to answer that from the department standpoint that that has been the way we have done things there was several instances in particular in the online role-alike conversations around moving the performance bands if we're going to be simple and consistent and we're going to be consistent we heard consistency with chronic absenteeism we

[01:32:37] heard consistency with mass theory index we did hear it would be more consistent if we had proficiency bands that were the same for high school science ela math and it was across the board we were talking apples to apples so we did hear feedback that from the field from our educators in particular they would like to see those consistency banding across the board for all assessments so that something like this could be apples to apples in every space right i'm going to

[01:33:11] move on from the mastery index oh mr other did you want to i just don't want to lose amber's i mean amber i i hear you and i'm not i'm not sure what i think about this so this isn't a lawyer question sorry deb um uh just we have so few kids at advanced so i mean i i i'm wrestling with two things i want to hear you think about one is okay we don't want to allow kids that advanced to be weighted in such a way that obscures low achieving students that's what's happened with averages and other things around the country here in virginia and so you mask low performance in in these in

[01:33:50] these averages as we all know averages you know obscure generally when they reveal at the same time are we want to incentivize getting kids to advanced right so for example like on nape eighth grade math NAEP, which is important and predictive, 1% of black students in Virginia are advanced. I mean, that should be front page news every week, in my view. We can do so much better.

[01:34:13] So how should we, like, I hear you on that jump from below basic to basic, and there's definitely a foundational skills issue there that's real. But how should we be thinking about these? I don't want to lose this idea that we also need to be moving kids. It's not just about getting to basic, it's about getting far beyond that. Absolutely. I mean, I guess in my mind, a 0.25 increment from proficient to advanced is reasonable. Again, we're not asking for the bigger jump that it's harder to get from below basic to basic, and then even basic to proficient is another jump.

[01:34:53] So I guess I like the idea values-wise that the move from proficient to advanced is, again, a quarter of a weight higher between the two versus, you know, the weights that we're seeing between below basic and basic, while still incentivizing the schools to do their best to move kids from advanced, I mean, from proficient to advanced. You know, our old system just ignored those kids, and so now we're saying, you know what, we're incentivizing those kids as well. We're not just going to put them in the proficient bucket, so to speak. We're going to incentivize, keep moving

[01:35:28] those kids ahead with an additional weight. But the weight's not overshadowing the weights that we're expecting at the other end of the spectrum. Does that make sense? Yeah. Ready to move on to the next topic. Next topic. I'm sorry. So we need direction. I love that we want to continue to move and I appreciate Dale's comment, but we need to give you clear next steps. If the goal is to have

[01:36:06] modeling for decision making, I would appreciate the board giving us some clear next steps of two or three things you want the team to do directionality so we can bring back things for decisions. So if you could help us as we go through today, make sure we're getting clear signals from the board so that we can prepare you for decisions in June and July.

[01:36:31] So should we pause here and like go deeper then on this? Because I don't know how after that conversation they would have direction it's retreat this is madam president maybe it's time to break out the sticky notes present increasing just please i'm just so i'm clear the next steps are at the next meeting we will be trying to decide what and so then that to me that will provide clarity around what what i would need in order to keep it moving which i'm excited to do

[01:37:08] So, Chad, non-Data English, do you want us to give you indications of where we are in terms of whether we want to look more at the standardized increments, proficiency, or do you want us to settle on weighted numbers?

[01:37:28] I mean, we're not voting today. Right, correct. So, to the extent that we can get clear direction for you all, if you all really liked the numbers that Amber suggested. Then you can model that out for us. We could absolutely do that. The other thing is if you said, we definitely don't like something like this high school that's getting really extra bonus points for advance.

[01:37:49] If you could give us clear direction that that is something, a red line you don't want to do, that would be helpful for us as well. Go ahead, Dr. Kins. So in the original timeline that the board provided the department, today is the retreat to really get signaling, discussion, lots of conversation, so that we can put things in front of you for first read on some of these key decisions in June, so that you have the data and have everything from the feedback, ongoing feedback, signals from the board now, so that in first read in June on some of these key areas, you have an opportunity to either vote or give us more direction so that we're still in the

[01:38:28] timeline that the board provided us. So that's kind of where we are. We need enough signaling from the board to give you some directionality in June so that you have things to make concrete decisions, or you can tell us, no, these don't work for us so that we can stay within the timeline that you've asked us to stay in. Dr. Siebert? I'd just like to check my understanding with Dr.

[01:38:48] Northern's approach here. So Dr. Northern, you're talking about 0.25 for below basic, 0.75 for basic, 1 for proficient, and 1.25 for advanced. And so that effectively creates an interval of five tenths. That's the boost from below basic to basic you were talking about, really incentivizing that.

[01:39:12] Then you get a 0.25 boost. So yeah, that's weighting that move from below basic to basic. um but also recognizing advanced is those is that what I heard you say okay I like that where the bump from four basic to proficient is the same as proficient to advanced but the bump from below basic to basic is you get more credit double the credit Ms. Hulton so uh I think this is a

[01:39:47] terrific discussion in the you know the I am I'm all for moving forward but I think the details do matter but I I think I'm hearing there's at least enough interest in Dr. Northern's model to want us to see more modeling on that option among the others. That would be my vote. But I also, I'm not comfortable committing to any of these until we've gotten some demographics data.

[01:40:13] So we know what we don't want is to have this system tell us that poor kids, poor schools are poor. We want it to identify the poor schools that are doing incredible work despite the demographics And

conversely, schools that are not doing well, despite advantageous demographics.

[01:40:35] So I'm really hoping we're going to see some modeling data before we make final decisions. And I don't know if you have any today. I haven't seen it in the slides, but I have asked for it. And I'm hoping, is that something we'll be able to see sometime before we make decisions?

[01:40:52] Yeah, our hopes we're building the system today so that we have something to build the model from. Great. We can't build it before we. So in other words, if we give you enough guidance on these specifics, then when you come back in June, you're going to be able to show us some demographic, lots of modeling data, including demographics. Thank you. That very much helps me.

[01:41:13] Dr. Northern and then Mr. Rotherham. So, Chad, I'm also on that point. We're going to see more of that, of what Ms. Holton's asking for on the growth measure, right? We all know that the growth measure is less correlated with race and income and poverty than the mastery index.

[01:41:34] So, you know, we ought to look at both. We ought to look at what the growth measure is telling us, what the mastery measure is telling us. And then I think where we're headed is we want to be able to see these individually, because that's what we've had in the problem in the past, we're clumping it all together. So I would just add that, you know, if you can run some simulations on the growth model as well, so we can look at them in comparison to the mastery model, so we have a fuller picture.

[01:42:00] mr rotherham i was just going to echo dr northern's part like my experience is it's going to say what it's going to say and we shouldn't shy away from that and so the the point i made about demographics is we do have to keep the eyes on the prize for mastery and we've got to make sure that we can measure growth and progress and we can then learn what's working and so i personally feel um very confident about the proficiency emphasis for where we are right now

[01:42:35] i would like to see you know the numbers that dr northam mentioned really just to see if we can see that same you know i think it's a slide forward you have the summaries like this minimal difference or there's you know there's huge differences just as a comparison but i would feel really confident, you know, if moving in the direction focused on the proficiency emphasis, even as it stands right now, because again, to Mr. Sterdiff's point, I think we have to start

[01:43:04] somewhere and learn and then not be stalled by too many details. Mr. Atherham? Yeah, I agree. I think, I mean, Ms. Holden, I'm struggling with, of course, we've not delivered education in this state in an equitable way. We know that. I mean, where do we want to start? 4% of Hispanic kids in Virginia are proficient in eighth grade. 1% of African-American kids. 60% of African-Americans

[01:43:40] in state are below basic. The commissioner of education of IES stood before this board and said below basic means you have literally no opportunity. You're simply unprepared. 60%. so any meaningful accountability measure is going to tell some hard truths and if we are sort of like well if it shows this then we can't do it or it can't be right like that seems like the moment that that we're at and as we've talked about growth in these schools is we should not expect that we're suddenly going to find all these schools that are low status and super high growth that has not been the experience anywhere else in the country wasn't the experience when

[01:44:17] No Child Left Behind introduced growth models. It hasn't been the experience since. And so I just think there's just some hard medicine that we've avoided taking because we've told everybody under

our accreditation system, nine out of 10 schools are fine. And we're either going to sort of get up to the cliff and look over again, or we're going to say, yeah, we're going to have to tell some hard truths there.

[01:44:39] so I'm not sure. I want to see the runs as well, but more because I kind of want to make sure these things have face validity, but it's going to show what it's going to show. We know that because we have not done a good job with a lot of kids for a long time. One of the things here that I don't want to have lost, though, is we keep talking about different communities. We have a good accountability system. It's also going to appear within schools, and so when I say 60 percent of African-American kids in eighth grade in the state are below basic, they're not all in the same at schools. They're not all concentrated in a particular part of the state. They're across the state, including in some of our really affluent communities where everybody thinks everything's

[01:45:17] going great. And so there's going to be just a lot of sort of hard truths that this is going to reveal. We're going to have to decide, okay, do we come together and address those or do we go back to trying to figure out ways to fuzzy it all up? And I think that's, I think as a values thing, that is where we are as, as a, as a board. And like the, the, the numbers, they're important.

[01:45:38] And, and, and I think it behooves us to weigh in what we're trying to do, but the fundamental gut check moment for this board is like, are we going to tell the truth or not? And if we simply say, well, if the truth shows these things, then it can't be the truth, or we shouldn't tell us that we're, we're not going to, we're not going to be anywhere. And you and I've had this conversation. We don't need to get into it again, but just, I have trouble figuring out the universe where we can solve any of these problems if we don't level set first on a fact base.

[01:46:06] And that may just be my consultant lizard brain, where when we go to solve a problem, we first build a fact base and then move from there. But I just don't see a world where we don't have that fact base, really know what's going on, and then move from there to make it better.

[01:46:21] Well, can I just get us back to where our feedback and our listening sessions took us? Because I think this is really important. We actually had a very deep conversation in one of the listening sessions where we had some really great positive feedback.

[01:46:39] We had a lot of teachers in the room and, you know, what they were concerned about after we talked through a lot of, you know, kind of getting through the unease of change was around, okay, we just want to make sure that our entire school division isn't going to be painted as the issues at this school. So now we all in every other school and division must do X, Y, or Z professional development when that is not our weakness in each school.

[01:47:12] They want exactly what we want this system to do, which is very clearly single out the issues that each school may have to address those weaknesses head on with whatever resources we need to address them with. But we had this conversation at this one listening session that was very, very collaborative and positive around, this is exactly what we want as practitioners. We want to be able to have those, we want to hone in on the weakness, we want to drive resources to it, and we want to

[01:47:50] fix what we know has been a long-standing problem that we've never had very specifically identified. And so that was a really big moment for me to hear that coming from the field, not just from what we've been talking about.

[01:48:07] So I thought that was extremely valuable. Right. I'm going to prepare to move us on. The one other thing I'll say, I don't know, Mr. Roth, if you want to, I'm not in charge here. Just on the modeling, I know we're throwing out, can we get some breakouts to help us understand this issue of making sure we're setting advanced in a way that's demanding and encourages that?

[01:48:31] but is it masking failure? We can talk like what kind of like analytic slices we can put on some of those runs to help us make sure we're getting that right. And then I also heard running growth and mastery modeling across each other. So one that you want to make sure that the modeling for June has clarity on whether mastery is masking below and how that might play out. And then one that pairs growth to mastery.

[01:49:01] Those are the two modeling pieces you'd like us to bring for June. Do you want them in all three different weighting categories or does it matter how we do the weighting categories when we bring that for June? So before we move on, I like this idea of the values piece and trying to maybe not create, not ask the model three and four things.

[01:49:26] So Dr. Northern, your approach, just a tiny issue, we're going into the hundredth place. which I just think, you know, complicates intuitive math for people. So I have two ideas, which I think maybe accomplish a little bit of both. We don't, again, back to the values, we don't want to overweight advance to mask anything, but we definitely want to give credit for making progress in lower levels.

[01:49:51] So I think one way could be, you know, use a 0.2, 0.7, 1, 1.2. And what a 0.2 to 0.7 to 1 to 1.2 does, it gives you 5 tenths from below basic to basic, gives you 3 tenths from basic to proficient, and then 2 tenths from proficient to advanced.

[01:50:12] Or if that was too big of a gap, if you wanted to make an equal interval in the lower levels, you could do 0.2, 0.6, 1.0. That way, between below basic to basic and basic to proficient, you're getting four tenths of an interval each time, and you're only getting two tenths of an interval when you're looking at advance.

[01:50:31] So I'm just trying to listen to everybody, make the values thing, and maybe kind of still advance the lower levels a little bit. I was just told there would be no math today.

[01:50:49] Always math. I don't know. I mean, you can run that as well. I just thought quarter increments were maybe easier than 10th increments, but it's all in the eye of the beholder, I think. I do think in all seriousness, Mr. Allman, I would say do the runs you need to show us some of the key trade-offs here.

[01:51:10] We don't want to mask low performance. We want to incent high performance. We want to see how growth and how it relates. Just help us with the key analytic perspectives. And I think rather than be like, we want these three or these two, I would defer to you and Ms. Heislop to figure out what are the ones that are going to allow us to really understand the dynamics that we need to wrestle with here.

[01:51:32] And there will be trade-offs and then how we should think about those and we'll have to collectively figure out what we think. So I just want to make sure I'm hearing you guys say that you're more, you're leaning more towards model two as opposed to model one. Is that right? The proficiency emphasis or no? Or do we need to model out more before we make that decision? Or not decision, but before we.

[01:52:07] I'm happy to use either Dr. Northern or one of Dr. Seabird's models as a starting point to come back to the board. It sounds like there's general agreement on something aligned there, general agreement not to have masking too high, general interest in models and want to know whether the models are masking, and general interest in other types of models and compare saying the master index to other sorts of data points as well.

[01:52:34] Right. And also not having advance be too low, though, because we don't want to create the effect where people focus, you know, exclusively. We need to make sure the focus is up and down the achievement continuum. That is good feedback for us. We will bring something back for you all to look at.

[01:52:54] The next thing we're going to talk about is actually a few different things, is measures to include in the system. And these are things that we've talked about as a board. We talked about with the stakeholders. We need your input on should these be in the first draft of the model or these things that we want to keep talking about and maybe develop at a later juncture.

[01:53:14] The first thing is growth in the elementary grades and particularly grades one to three. We would like your input or direction on whether you would like to see that and if so, which measure to use, whether that is linking vowels with the third grade proficiency.

[01:53:34] if it's something else of within grade or some other option? I don't know if Dr. Coons, you want to say any other things we heard from stakeholders on this question. Yeah, I think the goal to the modeling component into June is, is there an interest in the board since we got such diverse feedback and didn't get a clear signal to do grades one through three?

[01:53:56] And if there is an interest in the board and moving forward with the grades through one, three, three in some way, What measure do you want the team to be modeling off of? Because the modeling for VALS would be very different than doing any kind of modeling off of growth, in particular because the legislature passed flexibility with the Virginia Growth Assessment or something like iReady or MAP or other things.

[01:54:20] Those are very different modeling components around elementary growth that the team would have to go back and work on. So we need some signals from the board about whether you want us to lean into growth, where you want us to lean into growth in the early grades, what kinds of measures, and then bring back more nuances. Because if the board says we want to invest in potentially growth in VALS, we then need to go back to what expected growth looks like, what are the standardization, what are the parameters, what are the things we'd have to put in place so that you can make a really good final decision. So we need some signaling here to know what you want us to move forward

[01:54:59] with since we didn't have the feedback was pretty we may have gotten a letter here there that says one thing but the feedback overall is all over the place yeah can I put a stamp on that which is the thing I would took away from the feedback is there's interest in this concept but maybe not necessarily understanding the full consequences of what that interest would entail and so I we're interested in your feedback on as the board is is that enough to go forward and develop what one of measures be clear here on this um because i want everyone to hear and understand what's being

[01:55:34] asked and if we if we go with the the measure of vows that would mean every school division has to participate in that if we went with the one below where the growth is in in parentheses we would continue to operate on a system where some divisions are using iReady, other divisions are using MAT. Am

I understanding that to be the two options here? Yeah, let me say a little bit about that. So for VALS, I think you're right. It would have to be more standardized, both in terms

[01:56:13] of the administration procedure in the place that you use it, and it would have to be standardized statewide. So, there would be more scrutiny on, since it becomes essentially part of the accountability system, it would have to be standardized statewide, and that would be a change. So, this is what Dr. Solari presented on. So, for example, a one-to-one screener in less formalized standardized testing models might be much more limited, and we might put more parameters, which I think is what Ms. Holton mentioned in the letter from some of the academic supervisors is the concern. If you use VALS, what kind of parameters are you putting on a formative

[01:56:52] assessment? And I think Dr. Siebert, you mentioned this as well. Those are things that if the board wants us to explore using VALS, we would want to bring back in June, all of those narrowing of testing parameters that would have to be put in place to use something like that. So you would be able to make full, wide-eyes, open kind of decisions. We can't do all of that for you, but we want to know where you want us, what directionality you want us to go.

[01:57:20] I do want to give some input here as to what was heard very loudly and clearly in the listening sessions, which is we don't want more assessment. It might be an assessment that's in place of another assessment, but at the end of the day, I think it's still going to be seen and heard as more assessment. So personally, I think I would probably want to stay with the growth instead of VALs, but that's just because, you know, I want to honor some of the comments that

[01:58:00] we heard during our listening sessions about that. I really don't want to be rubbing school divisions the wrong way on that particular thing. Because like I said, I think any shift there is going to be seen as more and not in place of. That's just what I think. Ms. Holton? I think you're right. The clear message was not more assessments. And especially when we're at a time when, in theory, we're going to have better assessments. And I do think that we need to be

[01:58:36] thinking about what how what we're doing now works in the short term but also how it will work when we have better assessments which i hope and pray we do i've been the whole time i've been on this board which is a very long time now we've been talking about having real good growth measures throughout elementary school and and we're so far where the answer is we just don't have them uh one thing i wanted to be clear on is uh i i thought what and i'm basically hearing from the field they don't like vivas they don't like vows they don't want us to put weight on uh i

[01:59:12] ready etc map because they want that to be free from the pressures of an assessment system so i think what i thought i was hearing from the field is while we all want to measure growth through and i passionately want us to measure growth throughout elementary school they want us to punt on it for now meaning no way to grades one through three growth so i'm not sure if chad means that options

[01:59:36] Maybe that comes under other options. And I'm not the right one to be advocating for this because I've been pushing the opposite direction for so long. But, you know, maybe we just don't have real measures for growth that work for grade one through three. And maybe the best we can do is to use solely a four or five, a grade four or five growth measure for now with the hope and expectation and maybe direction that we want the next iteration of the assessment system to do better.

[02:00:06] I know other states, I mean, Chad and Ann can tell us this, but I know other states have growth measures that work throughout elementary school. Am I wrong? So the big problem here, and I'll just go out on a limb, is I think we're going to shoot ourselves in the foot because we have this, you know, Virginia Literacy Act putting all of this energy into the high quality curriculum, literacy coaches on and on and on.

[02:00:35] but we're not measuring whether kids are falling behind until third grade guess what they've already fallen behind we've now all that effort we put into pre-kk one and two has been you know to me has we're not measuring what we're doing so i thought we are measuring it but we just aren't measuring it in the accountability system thank you i appreciate it we actually are have one of the most extensive growth measures and PALS moving to VALS in the country. And I would say hardcore, I disagree that we're not measuring it. We do extensive work with VKRP and with early

[02:01:12] grades and with the VALS work. It is more formative than held in the accountability system. So the design is such that we are putting a weight on intervening and being formative and iterative instruction, but not holding that into our accountability model until later grades, which is the decision point that's here. And what Ms. Holton mentioned is we don't currently measure growth in the accountability system. We very much, and I just want to say that for the record, we very much have a deep system of measuring growth and have partnered with the University of Virginia and had the opportunity to talk with Emily Solari on Friday and Saturday

[02:01:52] about the nation-leading work we are doing measuring and literacy. So let me clarify and tell me, this is some areas I'd just like to explore for our next conversation. One is Ohio has been able to use multiple formative assessments, not just, I don't know what they call theirs, but for instance, I know that the NWA map, for instance, and the iReady, we can put those on the same scale as other tests.

[02:02:22] if we talk to our SAS guys, they may be able to tell us, yes, we can put these alternate assessments on the same scale as VAS. So we're, you know, we're standardizing these measures. So that's one thing I'd just be curious to know whether that's true that other states are able to do that. Second, what some other states do is report it, but they don't count it, you know, into any kind of weighting or system. And so if we're already measuring this, but we're not publicizing it or the public isn't aware. If it's just being used for formative purposes, I wonder too if it would

[02:02:56] be any benefit from just reporting it instead of counting it. I know many states just do a separate bucket of reporting. And then I guess my other question would be the on track. I was really thinking that my measure in my mind was what some states called on track to read by third grade. So it's just like, you know, can you identify in K-1-2 that there is no way on God's green earth they're going to be reading by third grade. And those are the kids I'd really like to identify so we can start intervening super early. And if we're already doing this formatively,

[02:03:32] then that's great. If we're already intervening earlier based on these formative assessments, that's fine. I guess I just would like somehow for that to be a little bit more transparently recognized. Mr. Rotherham? Can I ask an obvious potentially dumb question, but if we start using these this way, are they going to cease to be formative assessments in practice, and should we be concerned about that? Dr. James? I think that's what we heard in feedback, is using VALS and using iReady and NWA map, which the SAS, our current vendor, has already said that they have the

[02:04:10] stretch and they're using these in other states. It's the idea that using formative measures into an accountability system takes away the formative elements of that. And we heard that in pretty

consistently, both in the online sessions with the different organizations and from the field. I just want to, you know, before we make this into an or, I like the idea that I'm hearing that there is a potential and here, because again, I heard very strongly that we want VALS to remain a very formative assessment. And of course, you know, we put it into a

[02:04:46] statewide system, then we get into security and a whole bunch of different things. But back to Dr. Northam's point, if the VALS data is prominently published, like in its own little bar for the primary grades, primary grades are hugely formative, so we want them to remain formative. But put the primary grades, the VALS data published, and yes, it's a formative tool.

[02:05:09] And then, you know, some people, oh, what if that got gamed or something like that? No, I think third grade reading is still like the gatekeeper to see if that's been done well and done right. So I like the idea of maybe report some things, wait other things, and keep this as an end.

[02:05:26] Now, if there's a way that Dr. Coons just pointed out to stitch together some other tools, I think that is very, very cool. But again, then we get into the concern about overassessment. Madam President, I'd love to hear more about, and Dr. Northern touched on it, but Chad, can you tell us more?

[02:05:46] What are other states doing, and are they using things like iReady, MAP, formative assessments in ways that don't take away the formative value of them, you know, and add all this extra security? And I do think, back to Grace's point, more test apparatus, more assessments and or more apparatus security, et cetera, around assessments is one thing where we heard loud and clear that the divisions don't want.

[02:06:17] But can we do what other states do around these without all those trappings? Yeah, we looked into this and there we could not find any other state that's including K2 growth in their formal state federal accountability system. And because of some of the concerns that you're raising of turning that into a federally compliant test means more security concerns and having a set time, basically following all the protocols that you would need for an SOL, applying that in K2.

[02:06:50] And so that is why other states, I think, have come to a similar conclusion. But I hear you say K-2, so is third grade a different scenario? Third grade, I can't think of any growth measures. There are some states that are double counting third grade, so placing a separate emphasis.

[02:07:08] We've talked about this at the board level in the past to say we want to call out third grade reading proficiency as a separate standalone indicator, essentially double counting that grade. and that's where what we have done but we're now backing we're giving our we've done that recently but we're giving divisions more flexibility around that because it didn't work as intended

[02:07:42] i'm just wondering for the next meeting if you could not because i know they just passed it you ohio we do so much work in ohio my day job um can you look into their on track to read by third grade measure and see what they're doing it's it's cut off the presses um and i'm just curious frankly um how they've how they're squaring uh the same issue we looked into ohio's a month or so ago and at the time it wasn't used for federal purposes and so maybe that's how they're getting around some of these issues okay okay they're just are they using their state they're saying

[02:08:18] they have a separate state system yeah that's right separate indicators for that state system other comments what else do you need before we move from this i'm not hearing any strong support for this measure at this point in time we can continue to keep it in the background percolating if we come up

with other brilliant ideas or if there's other things that come to mind but for now i'm not hearing strong board support or including one of these measures in at least the

[02:08:59] summer modeling work that we're going to be able to do is that accurate and fair everybody have a comment well i support them on my own i just think that it comes back to the inadequacy of our assessment system and so i i do hope we can have uh an update and maybe that's on the work plan i don't remember but soon on where are we moving with our assessment system and are we going to have better measures

[02:09:32] soon that will meet these nodes dr canes yeah we are um currently finalizing the rfp um to move forward with that so we hope we could probably provide you an update in june pretty extensively because the rfp should be out and available and in i'm looking to katie by by the june board meeting we should be able to have a full update on where we're moving with that direction thank Thank you. Yep. Dr. Coons, this might make a nice segue to the performance task. Do you want to do an introduction of that and sort of what we heard from the field?

[02:10:06] Are you asking me to do that? I'm happy to do that for you. President Creasy, would you like me to do that as well? Okay. So one of the things that we heard in between the first series of listening sessions and the next step was something that measured readiness with chronic absenteeism, chronic absenteeism was not a standalone measure and something that leaned into the five c's so to miss holton's point around innovations with assessment and what are other states doing that are more robust and more innovative we asked our current provider to give us some sample assessments that are performance task based that are extremely innovative that provide innovative

[02:10:45] results and we do have in our budget right now to do a singular performance task in fifth grade and so we asked that provider to give us some sample of ready existing tasks that would not take development um norming all of the validity and reliability components which are off-the-shelf uses and we provided those in the feedback session two samples of performance tasks that allow students to virtually get online have an interest-based selection of a task that tasks walks them through five c's critical decisions how they would collaborate what they could do in that

[02:11:22] space, and then they would have to communicate their solution at the end. We heard very strong positive feedback around the fifth grade performance test, as Dr. Siebert mentioned in his conversation, as you saw earlier, and the opportunity of using this kind of nod to the five C's, which is an important emphasis, a nod to this is really an authentic way to measure whether or not students are really ready and the fact that it would not lean into teachers having to grade those performance tasks and putting additional burdens on teachers what we heard around the performance

[02:11:59] task is if the board moves forward please look at your assessment systems so it's not adding additional assessments to fifth grade per se and how we can manage the body of assessments and bulk of assessments to make sure as you see in that fourth bullet more of a balanced approach And then as you think about this performance task, make sure that the test modifications and pieces in the performance task support multilingual learners, students with disabilities, and have all of the accoutrements that a true performance task would lean in.

[02:12:33] So that was what we heard from the field, both in the first listening session, what you provided for feedback in the second listening session, and kind of the comments around the performance tasks that

we heard throughout the past three weeks. What we need from the board today would be, do you agree that that is a direction you would like to proceed?

[02:12:58] If so, what we would do is probably present at the next session on the assessment side of what that would look like from the assessment angle. From the accountability perspective, we would want to think about how it might be included. If you're going in that direction, that would give us some signal of we should think about how to include it in the accountability system as well.

[02:13:21] Any comments, questions, feedback on the idea of the performance tasks? either elementary or middle middle i'm not sure where we're going have we talked about the middle

[02:13:35] yet oh yeah okay i had someone ask what the five c's were from the field so that would include critical thinking creative thinking communication collaboration and inclusive of citizenship skills

[02:14:12] so it would allow for all of those components to be measured in a performance task which is something our schools do locally but this would allow us to lean in and get a true readiness measure and authentic measure. We can at lunch certainly provide the copies that we provided during listening sessions so you could see what those authentic tasks look like, but we did get a lot of positive feedback. I think the only concern we got would be helpful from the board as we move forward if the board is interested in including a performance task is how might we adjust assessments to make sure that we're balancing the amount of assessments in fifth

[02:14:51] grade, given that is a particularly heavily assessed year. Yeah, lots of interest in the idea. There's always a question about the details. And one would be to look at the grade level, because you even heard in the feedback, there are some schools that aren't K-5. And so if it was like a fourth grade assessment, or even, you know, depending on how it was created, you know, there could be some flexibility there for division to decide, we're going to do this in fourth grade, we're going to do this in fifth grade. Dr. Coons, anything else you'd want to say on the middle

[02:15:29] school performance task? Sure. So this was an evolution and I talked to President Creasy after our first week. So after we left the board meeting March 28th, we immediately had three listening sessions the following week. And one of the clear pieces of feedback is they liked the performance task in elementary so much that they wanted us to provide some options for the middle school readiness as well. And they wanted something on the academic career plan that Dr. Siebert mentioned before that we use really heavily in K-7, K-8 to help students start to think about their readiness for high school, to start thinking about their plans. And we heard from the field that

[02:16:09] if we really want something at the end of middle school that represents middle school for all learners, maybe we should also, along with those advanced courses, add something like a middle school readiness task. So we very quickly, between week one and week two of listening sessions, put some ideas together around what a performance task could look like that would allow for a lean into those career readiness plans, allow a lean into those five C's and help students think critically about what they had been doing, what they would need to be successful in high school as they're developing their interests in high school and what kind of reflection and what kind

[02:16:48] of components they would need. I think this is something that is less ready off the shelf. We talked about an elementary ready off the shelf component. The interest in the middle school performance task is definitely something that is innovative and an opportunity to continue to expand the five C's. I

would say that in our fast look, and again, we have not done an exhaustive research, in our fast look, we have not necessarily seen anyone using a career readiness plan in a performance task to measure readiness for high school. So this would be something new. We have

[02:17:23] talked to a couple of providers about doing research for us, and they are in the process of bringing some things back. But this is pretty fast turnaround and ask around what that could be from a middle school perspective. What we would need from the board is given the interest in elementary, this would have, adding this to middle school would have budgetary impact. It would have RFP impact for the assessment suite that we are moving and working on. It would also have impact in getting information back to you for June so that you could see really baked out models. Like

[02:18:00] we'll bring back the elementary models that are ready and in use, but having something for middle school, we'll have to get those baked out for a reaction in June. What we need to know, is there an interest in the board in one, thinking about the budgetary component, two, as we move forward with the assessment RFP, putting the middle school performance task in that assessment RFP, and three, bringing back real built-out models for the middle school component of the readiness space for the performance and support framework. So those are things we would really need help in to make sure that we're preparing for what you need in June. So this is a question for Dr. Siebert.

[02:18:40] what was it, about 2013, 2014, there came a requirement, I think, from the General Assembly on middle school career readiness seminars or something along that. Nothing assessment-oriented in any way, but more of a, do we know kind of what level that program's, where it currently

[02:19:11] I mean, I remember when I was kind of leaving the classroom, it was still very much in its infancy. And we had just the school counselor going in and talking about future careers. I mean, is that particular piece a place that we could build kind of this out of?

[02:19:31] I do see that if in any way, shape or form that we create this performance task opportunity at the middle school level, it certainly has to be extremely collaborative, cross-curricular, buy-in type opportunity in order to really reap all of what we want to get out of it.

[02:19:58] So I guess, Dr. Siebert, I'm giving you a bunch of questions, comments, thoughts in one. So, Madam President, I'm going to try it very lightly because the other Dr. Siebert in my house runs Virginia Career Review, and I don't dare want to misspeak on her career's work.

[02:20:15] But yes, first of all, I like the idea of using things we already have and expect. And we already expect in the Commonwealth of Virginia that children have an academic career plan. What happened, I think, Madam President, what you're referring to is a few years ago, the idea of the academic career plan took a step forward to require that each child have an ACP, that each child move forward and they would have an ACPP, which is an academic career plan portfolio.

[02:20:45] As soon as you say the word portfolio, assessment people go, oh, my gosh. But that is already an expectation that is there. And so the idea, and then the next problem that happened is because the ACPP, the portfolio, became a requirement, but it wasn't standardized by the Commonwealth, there's been this divergent evolution.

[02:21:04] So you have some school divisions with resources using pretty sophisticated tools. You have other school divisions building things out in their Google Docs environment and whatever else. So there's been this divergent thing. So, you know, maybe, again, go back to always trying to get to end.

[02:21:20] You know, since it is required that there be an academic career plan, it's required that children, I think by seventh grade, might be misspeaking there, have to have an academic career plan portfolio, then there might be the opportunity for a child to use their portfolio, however they've constructed it, in a performance task.

[02:21:35] And so that I think could potentially be exciting, but a lot of question marks there. In addition, I think we did institute a course requirement, and I'm not quite sure what the status of it is, but there is, I think, a semester-long course requirement in middle school now focused on careers and career planning and career options.

[02:22:04] And I know that we've added that requirement. What I don't know is whether we have an SOL or other curricular guidance from the state. So I don't know what the content of that course is, but I think it is something that I think I'm right that DOE has put out a content guidance on that course.

[02:22:30] I just don't know what it is. So I wonder if there's something that course could be used to. I just, instead of totally. Yeah. Right. Build on what we've got.

[02:22:54] No, I am not the right person to answer that question here. Yeah. Can I ask a different question about the middle school? I think this is similar to the third grade growth conversation, and I just want to put it out there. When we talk about formative measures and VALs and growth measures, we want to make sure that if we apply to the federal government and their ESSA plan for something that counts for accountability, we want to make sure the same.

[02:23:21] I'm all about the portfolio and using something we all have, but I think you would want us to investigate on whether or not that can be used in an ESSA system and be valid and reliable. So if that's the direction y'all decide as you're having conversations, make sure that we will have to go back and figure out the standardization, the reliability and validity of what we do have and if we would have to shift that at all.

[02:23:46] So that's just something to keep in mind as you're having a conversation. So am I correct in understanding if we went in that direction, we would be using that somehow in addition to some metric of high school course taking in middle school?

[02:24:07] And so I'm seeing nods yes. So to the extent we keep some component of high school taking into middle school, I do see that we've gotten a lot of comment back to the effect that the problem of the current shortage of high school endorsed teachers at the middle school level, which would particularly impact rural or high risk middle schools.

[02:24:33] Is there an answer to that? What's the solution to that? I had a brief conversation with Virtual Virginia, so I don't want to commit to anything, but we are going to have a meeting with them in the next few weeks to talk about some of those concerns in general. Ms. Hulton, we've heard about middle school, we've heard about some of the high school opportunities, some of the spaces.

[02:24:53] We are also thinking about some of the licensure flexibility and those opportunities to make sure that we're leaning in in that space. So we are definitely researching options as we speak based on the listening session feedback over the past three weeks. And I think very clearly was that, you know, and look, you're going to hear on Thursday, I'm really excited about this.

[02:25:16] You're going to hear from our student advisory committee, our advisory board. And that is one of those things that they talked about is that they weren't a lot of the advanced coursework wasn't

accessible to them in a lot of our rural areas.

[02:25:33] And so I had hoped, I guess maybe my hope was and was never came to fruition, but we had spent quite a bit of money that came from the federal government during COVID to really stand up virtual Virginia more than it was.

[02:25:52] And I had kind of hoped that we were in a really great place there, but obviously we're, it didn't go as far as we needed to go with that sort of upscale at the time. But I think, you know, I think it's a conversation that we should have in the future as to whether or not that's really the answer or whether we have other opportunities.

[02:26:17] I think we probably want to look at licensure options, too. And I think that's another thing that we need to be examining. I'm not sure what licensure option means. If it means asking somebody to teach Algebra I in middle school who is not trained to teach Algebra I, then that's not a good solution.

[02:26:40] No, I guess my point is that, for example, we had different grade levels. We have licenses that have our licensure process has ebbed and flowed for so many years. And, for example, I hold a 612 license.

[02:26:56] Some people hold a 6.8 license. other people. And that was just based on the timing of when people were in the initial licensure portal getting into it. So maybe we need to make sure that we do have more 612 licensees. That's kind of one of my solutions that I'm thinking about. And do we know, is it, do we have any data on how many of our middle schools are currently equipped to teach algebra one in particular, since that's, I think, one of the key courses.

[02:27:28] You know, we definitely have data on middle school. And for the most part, what we heard in the listening sessions is most people have middle school math teachers endorsed to teach algebra.

[02:27:46] It was more about the biology, the chemistry, and some of the sciences and other areas that people were more concerned about advanced coursework in middle school. But I do think we have talked about having community college and college professors come into our schools and having some licensure flexibility and the ability to teach some of the advanced coursework and having that opportunity.

[02:28:07] So there are a lot of options in the licensure world that we need some flexibility, and we have some experts that we are not tapping into in a way that we have possibilities. So I think we've explored that through the legislative session, but need to continue to explore ways to take highly qualified subject matter experts and make sure that they have the opportunity to teach it in our spaces.

[02:28:32] Yeah, I'll just say that, I mean, just broadly, I'm in favor of continued exploration of a middle school performance task. I mean, I think it feels, I mean, we're going to discuss the advanced coursework in a minute and the eligibility for students for that is going to be really important, I think, to that discussion.

[02:28:52] But it does feel a little skinny to me, this 20% middle school bucket, if it's, you know, advanced coursework and chronic absenteeism. I think the performance task, if we can pull it off, would make that bucket a little meatier and more substantive. So clarification, yes. Explore the middle school task coursework, explore it in correlation, bring back costs, bring back requirements, bring back those pieces for the board in June.

[02:29:26] Great. I'm going to transition us to a discussion on middle school advanced coursework. There are lots of different options here. And so we want your feedback on should this be included? And if so,

how? A couple of pieces of data just to include in the conversation.

[02:29:47] One is that of Virginia schools with an eighth grade, most about 97 percent have at least one student who passed the Algebra 1 EOC. So most eighth grade or eighth grade schools have at least one student passing the Algebra 1 EOC.

[02:30:06] The other point that I think is relevant here is among middle schools who are taking the Algebra 1 and of course assessment, their pass rates are very high. The school level median statewide is about almost 98%. So what that suggests to me is that potentially schools are not being as aggressive as they could be about putting more students in because basically everyone who takes it is passing it um the last thing i'll say is that the florida version of this indicator florida has uh middle school advanced coursework in their accountability system they have other things besides math in it

[02:30:42] and we can talk about that but the one thing that they do is they limit the denominator to students who score proficient in seventh grade so they're essentially saying to districts and divisions if you have students that are ready to be successful in advanced math we're going to hold you accountable for whether you're actually giving them that opportunity or not.

[02:31:01] And so that would be one option of ways to narrow this indicator to focus on the kids who are academically performing well and not just pushing students who aren't necessarily ready into that. So I'll throw that out there. The other thing to note on this conversation is the question of whether it's limited to math or whether we broaden it.

[02:31:19] The stakeholders, some of their feedback was they were interested in other topics, particularly foreign language. Dr. Coons mentioned some of the challenges with staffing, some of the advanced courses in sciences and other things. So the other thing, the reason that math is the starting point is because it does have the end of course assessment, whereas other ones are more about the credit that a student earns and it's less hard.

[02:31:45] It's less standardized across the Commonwealth. So I will pause there. Again, this is a conversation about, one, should we include some form of advanced coursework in middle school readiness? And two, how should we define that? Whether we should limit it to math, whether we should include other subjects, and how to limit it to the denominator or other things?

[02:32:11] I think that in terms of readiness measure, advanced coursework for middle schools makes sense. I do think this is a place where we probably need to start small and do it well, and then later we can decide about expanding. So, you know, based on the data you've given, my understanding of schools, I think probably starting with math is a good place to start.

[02:32:31] I think that, you know, as we get back to the middle school piece, we talk about the mastery piece, we can really think about the eighth grade writing and other things that are very, very important for middle school. But I think starting small and doing it right is probably more important than trying to start it too big and making it too complex.

[02:32:48] Back to the math piece, I think that many middle schools are equipped for that, are providing that. And I also like the idea that for some children, developmentally, they are not ready. I think about my own three children, the ones that were developmentally ready for algebra in middle school and the ones that maybe were not.

[02:33:08] And also, again, that then comes back to the great standards work we've been doing. Because the other risk is when you accelerate seventh graders in algebra and eighth graders into geometry, you have really advanced math students come along who really haven't done interest and mortgages and a whole bunch of other math skills.

[02:33:25] So there seems to be some thoughtfulness there. But I think if we go this direction, we should start small. I guess I do see a path, though, outside of just algebra.

[02:33:42] I mean, we need advanced coursework for kids in as many. If we're really talking about student choice and providing them options and opportunities, then we need to have more flexibility and opportunity than just in math.

[02:34:02] Because I can tell you, I probably would have been advanced in English and in social studies and definitely not in math. But, I mean, so I don't want for students who are not particularly the math students to feel as if they're left out of opportunities for high school credits or more advanced coursework.

[02:34:30] I don't want us to put all of our eggs in one basket. So that's just my point of view. We're moving, Madam President. Oh, I'm sorry. I'm sorry, Ms. Kilgore. Apologies. I think you can start smiling more than one option.

[02:34:51] And I totally agree with what President Creasy said. You know, not everyone, you don't want students to feel like if they're not strong, we want them to be strong. We want to encourage strength in math, but we also want to encourage strength in English and science.

[02:35:08] And so I think you could do both. Start small, but often with one option. I agree, Matt, but that's the, I want to tie that together. What's the range of things we could be thinking about? help us? We've got new personalized options and so forth. Let's start from like, what's the universe of things we could consider here beyond algebra? Obviously, geometry for kids who take algebra in seventh grade, but what else? If we're talking about all the things under the sun, we heard things like foreign language. We heard things like CT options. We heard a lot of concern

[02:35:47] around the science progression and making sure the science progression. We currently get a waiver from the feds about offering algebra one in middle school. We would have to get a waiver for biology as well if that was something. We heard arts, fine arts, having fine arts options. We heard a lot of different creative things. I think the thing that this board will have to consider is what is a high school bearing course, when you start talking about widening that and thinking about fine arts and all of those things, and how do you know that the integrity of the course was actually a high

[02:36:27] school course? And that a child carried the credit bearing level of a high school course in middle school. So if you're thinking about advanced coursework and you're thinking about this as a readiness course, there are some structures that you'll need to think about when you widen it beyond Algebra 1 is the foreign language. What is the course content? What is the measure that the student worked at that high school readiness level? And how wide and exploratory do you want

[02:36:58] that to be? Perhaps maybe we need to start looking at some data about what school divisions are offering, let's say, for example, foreign language to middle schoolers. And what does that translate to so you know so for example is is their spanish one separated into an a and b course so you take the first half of spanish one in grade seven and the second half of grade eight i mean so you might

[02:37:33] have some school divisions that do that um or how how are they how many are offering and and what's their enrollment in those offerings please yeah i like this conversation direction and i agree starting small but you know i like the ends my hypothesis will be we've got the data that a lot of middle schools do offer algebra so we know there's capacity there i think we're going to see a lot of middle schools offer world languages now some offer four world languages some five some two but i think world language will be a pretty big possibility i think where we run the risk of

[02:38:11] upsetting a program of studies that an individual division has created is when we start talking about the sciences and the histories because there are school divisions next door to each other down region six where world geography is available in the eighth grade um where the division next door chooses to do that as ninth grade similar with earth science and so whatnot um so i think the the world i think in terms of the packing order of numbers you're gonna have large numbers of algebra being available you have world languages being available but i think if you start moving to science and history we're going to start interrupting programs of studies yeah i would

[02:38:48] just like to see a list and if it exists but just of everything we've talked about that you asked for Madam President, also with methods for verifying it, like in that just what mechanisms do we have to verify to Dr. Kunz's point that it actually is a high school level course. And that could be obviously we have, and of course, SOLs in certain instances, we may have other things that may be externally done in the cases, but just helping us understand just as a board, the range of options that Ms. Creasy asked for, but then how we could think about addressing this issue and making sure they're actually rigorous we do have a little data to share with you today on the percentage of

[02:39:27] students who you take in grade eight high school math is 46 high school science is 12 high school history or social studies is 13 and high school world language is 46 so math and world languages are the higher they're both around 46 of eighth graders who are taking credit cards that works Great. Sorry, I didn't mean to interrupt the conversation, but I thought that would be relevant.

[02:39:54] Dr. Northern? So I just want to underscore bullet three because I think readiness and narrowing the denominator is key to this whole discussion. I do believe that we run the danger of watering down courses and to Mr. Rotherham's point of what's a real high school class.

[02:40:11] I mean, they can call it a high school class, but it's so I like Florida's approach and it actually has another element as well. So it's, again, you're only sort of eligible to do this if you score proficient in seventh grade in said subject, if you choose to enroll in an EOC in eighth grade, and also if in the sixth, seventh, or eighth grade you took a test for high school industry certification, which I like that because then it opens it up to our CTE folks who, you know, are going to go in that pathway in high school.

[02:40:41] So I think as long as we are, you know, insightful about who goes in the denominator, who's already shown, you know, some level of preparation to take an advanced course, then that's most important to me. I think the other thing that we have the opportunity to do, and I know we said this a lot during the listening sessions, is we have structured middle school and high school so long around a Carnegie unit that was designed in 1906.

[02:41:10] And I had the opportunity over the weekend to hear Carnegie say, we would like to remove that from anyone's vocabulary because we shouldn't be running middle school and high school around 180 hours for a course. And the legislature passed seat time flex, and we want to make sure we lean into providing those flexible options and those opportunities. So as we think about verifying a course and

making sure it has rigor and it has that, we also can lean into the opportunities that we no longer have to have a Carnegie unit to consider a course, a rigorous course, to consider a course, a credit-bearing course.

[02:41:49] So we have an opportunity to really be flexible and think differently. Yeah, I was trying to think, how do we start small? But then everything you all just said went way, way big. And so, which I appreciate, I want to also make sure computer science is put as an option or elevated or encouraged, given, I think, the digital world that we operate in.

[02:42:18] One question I'm wondering about is writing. Is there a writing research project or something that is another opportunity? And then the other wondering I have is, like, could we, with a certain requirement, offer kids a virtual course where they could explore options that doesn't require someone in the building to teach, which goes to the flexibility around Carnegie or not.

[02:42:48] But if a student engages in a certified or rigorous virtual course, could that be counted? And as you all were talking, though, the thing that I think is the challenge is, like, who's going to teach it?

[02:43:06] And so how do we make sure we are given the options? How do we make sure that we are flexible in thinking about that? And then the last, you know, I, I really, I appreciate the Florida approach around like a criteria and that opens up, that opens up options. I think I'm, I'm also, I was concerned about if you're not a math kid, then you never get the chance to try something that is more rigorous or that you hadn't been exposed.

[02:43:42] So you're always in the catch up, you're always in the remediation, you're always in the growth. And, you know, just from from my experience, like we teach computer science at sixth grade for everybody just to give them the exposure to it. And you would really be surprised by the time they're 11th grade there.

[02:43:59] I mean, I have kids who are like, I'm a computer science geek that if you saw them at sixth grade, they would have never even thought about that. So how do we balance the, yes, you are proficient, you should be on this track versus, like, kids just need exposure to new things, and that will open up opportunities at high school.

[02:44:19] Madam President, if I may, a little bit of this made me a little uncomfortable. We're talking about, like, who's a math person, who's not? Like, every kid is a math person, right? We decide, I mean, and I'll share, like, my daughter's in elementary school. I don't talk about them a lot, but they started coming home from school and talking about which one of them was going to be a math person and which one wasn't.

[02:44:39] They're identical twins. They're genetically identical, right? Something was happening to them in school that was sending a signal about which one might be the math kid or not. And that's crazy. And we just need to make sure that we're sending. So the direction we go, and I do think we want to be thoughtful about the denominator because we need this accountability system to it needs to make sense.

[02:45:02] But we also need to make sure we're exposing to a full range of options. A virtual point was good. And that we're even earlier in the pipeline. This goes back to elementary school accountability pieces that we're not sending signals to kids when they're, you know, literally eight, nine, 10 years old about what kind of like person they are.

[02:45:21] That's not what we should be about. So one other opportunity to look at is, you know, there are school divisions and schools within school divisions that are teaching some pretty creative courses that are different than what, you know, we expect them to be teaching.

[02:45:40] So, for example, their school in middle schools, they're teaching creative writing courses. And, you know, are there are there school divisions that have those opportunities? And a lot of it's because of student choice and also, you know, what a teacher might have expanded interest in from what that teacher is teaching.

[02:46:03] So instead of just English 6, maybe that teacher really wants to go deeper and teach a creative writing course or something like that. Do we have school divisions that are offering more than just the cookie cutter that we're asking them to offer?

[02:46:20] What are those things that are out there? And is that stuff, are those courses reported to us so that I can frame an idea around that? I have to kick that to the VUE folks. my sense is we have fairly good data on the uh transcripts of what classes students are taking so we could get some information about that the question then becomes like how do you measure whether it's a rigor rigorous course or rigorous option or not um we can look into that what I'm hearing from the board is general interest in this idea uh general interest in narrowing the

[02:46:59] denominator to something so it's not penalizing students or pushing students to advance that aren't ready and then potentially thinking about how to have a broad measure that students would have options as in addition to math does that sound right for what people think all right um I'm gonna we're gonna keep moving up the grade level we're gonna go to uh high school readiness

[02:47:23] i'm gonna turn this back to anne sure before we wrap this up and there um the next several

[02:58:51] are focused on high schools now um you know we've been talking about readiness at the middle school level at elementary schools and now this is the high school readiness um indicator one component of it the new what we're calling the ready for life indicator this would be a um sort of taking the place of the cccri which is what's in gray on the left side of the slide so the new indicator so the direction that we're thinking based on the stakeholder feedback is this indicator would recognize college career military and civics options for students to demonstrate their readiness

[02:59:27] for um whatever path they have beyond high school so there are a few key changes here i think we We heard loud and clear from stakeholders that it was important to continue sort of the dual enrollment credit. That was one thing that they're very supportive of.

[02:59:43] But we do have here that this would be based on the exam scores from AP, IB, and Cambridge as opposed to just sort of participation in class. So really sort of demonstrating that readiness through the exam scores and more meaningful outcome of that experience, not just participation in it.

[03:00:00] there are a few things around one things that we've heard is that you know not all cte credentials are created equal so this would sort of really emphasize a state approved in demand cte credential and some of the career and military options we also heard a lot of possible feedback around the inclusion of the asthma exam and sort of that military career right so it's not just any ASVAB support but an ASVAB support that allows um enlistees to really choose their career in the military so that sort of meaning this emphasizing more meaningful outcomes over

[03:00:38] just experiences of patients and within the civics component you know really trying to maintain the service learning experience um that was something we heard a lot of positive feedback from from the stakeholders about how important that was how they really worked to incorporate that into their high schools and really trying to make that something that's more standardized and measurable the same goes for work-based learning we got very similar feedback that the work-based learning experiences were important along with um the service service learning and the civics and so i think we didn't get great consensus on sort of another civics measure beyond service-based learning um but

[03:01:17] we do think that there's a way that we could still incorporate that and make it meaningful um given the stakeholder feedback that we got so i think that you know this what we're trying to sort of do with this new version of the indicator is it's sort of like ready for whatever a student a student isn't just sort of slotted into one pathway that they actually have meaningful choices for what they can do beyond high school that they're not just you know on the career track they're not just on the college track they can choose what option is right for them and recognize

[03:01:46] that that indicator uh so the basic the the differences first of all just so i can understand on the the top line is that dual enrollment credit will be the same from current to the proposed new indicator but that for ap ib and cambridge will you'll now instead of getting credit for enrolling

[03:02:21] you have to pass yeah it's trying to use that right and so what pass score you know ap it's you know three four or five there's a range of pass scores what would we propose to be using is my first question and i'll lump the second question in which is i think i saw some feedback from various places that the assessment costs something so that it's a barrier in school you know for families that can't afford to pay the cost of the ap assessment that that's a barrier i don't know what that cost is and is there a solution to that so speaking on the first point i think we have not

[03:03:01] that into the specifics of this but i'm going to speak to what other states do that use ap id and cambridge exams is they typically use a three for the ap and for id they usually use a four because those are the scores that is generally accepted by colleges as getting credit so it's really looking at you know what do our four-year universities in virginia public schools what do you need to do in general on an AP or IV exam in order to get post-secondary credit for that

[03:03:34] course when you enroll. And then on the point about the cost associated, there are AP IV exam fees. Federal funds can be used to pay for those. There's, you know, through the Title IV specifically.

[03:03:53] So that is the choice that some districts use. There's also, I think, ways to try and get fee waivers you know so i think that it can be a barrier but there's also then resources out there to help divisions cover the cost for students who you know that exam fee would be um prohibiting them so that's great to know their resources if the question is whether those resources are adequate to meet the need so can we get any data on what the is there any data that will help us understand what schools are currently doing on paying those fees and is there a way that we can uh help boost

[03:04:31] that or or any reflection on how this using this in the accountability system will affect that i can certainly i think we could pull the amount of that title four funds i think um which is the pot of funds that can be used for it it's just kind of allowed oh i'm not close enough to the mic or just chat as much taller than i am you're too short i was saying that we have um districts can use a division can use that money for a lot of different purposes so i think i'm not sure there would be a data source that shows exactly like this is what went for fees so i guess i'm just

[03:05:11] i'm hearing that a lot of divisions i i somehow i feel like we ought to be able to find out is it it the case now that many people have to pay for their own assessments? And if so, is there a solution? I think this was when it came up in the listening sessions, a lot of the stakeholders were saying, and that's why it's really important that dual enrollment is also included. Dual enrollment.

[03:05:36] Well, some of that, sometimes that costs too, but maybe that problem has been solved. I don't know. It used to be that students had to pay for their dual enrollment costs too, but maybe they don't anywhere. I would hope that if we set a bar like this, that we then have, and whether that's something that happens over the General Assembly with federal funds, that we should be making sure every kid who wants to take one of these tests can take it regardless of economic circumstances.

[03:06:04] That seems just very straightforward. That's what other states have done. And so it'll be incumbent on us to, we obviously can't spend the money, but there's things we can do through regulation. There's things we can do through the bully pulpit. And this is a very doable thing. Again, other states have done it. So setting an ambitious bar here, we should not set it because we should expect people to do that. I would want us to take a look on AP credit, Ms. Holton's question. I think we should take a look at probably my suggestion would be, what does Virginia Tech, UVA, William & Mary? Because I do think we want to make sure we don't

[03:06:41] have a kid getting, say, a three on biology, and then they go down to Blacksburg, and you need a four or five to get credit there, art history, there's different, at some of these different schools, things like that, and I just want to make sure, like, this is, the part of the point of this is to make sure it's aligned, and so we want to make sure those signals are aligned, and those three terrific universities right here seem like a good place to maybe set a benchmark for what our expectations are, because it'll vary by time. Mr. Rotherham, I'm trying so hard not to argue with you today and so you're saying lots of things that i've objected to i will say particularly characterizing prior acts of this board and i'm trying so hard to resist but this one i cannot

[03:07:18] resist there are a lot of great universities in virginia and those three are absolutely terrific and and the highest bar in virginia there are lots of others and i would if if the odu and vcu and george mason accept a three and uva doesn't i would think we should accept a three well okay that's fair miss holden i think like that was not to cast aspersions on any there are great universities if you're our last lab committee meeting we were just talking about george mason my point is i think we want to make sure we have some kind of a clear standard that's anchored to something and if it could well be we look and say what's the minimum at any public university in the

[03:07:55] commonwealth it could be what we look at it but it has to have i just want to make sure it has some logical that we don't just decide it's a three we need to figure out what does that look like so So it's aligned with expectations across the Commonwealth. We can see if that data is available through SHEV or do some additional, like look at all the four-year universities and see if we can find if there's any sort of uniform guidance around AP course acceptance and get a good sense.

[03:08:20] And same thing with IB. I believe, I'm not sure, I think some universities give an IB, like UVA may give an IB preference, I'm not sure. But just to make sure, just that it's anchored in something that creates a coherent through line through post-secondary. Dr. Norther? So I just want to make sure that we're casting a wide net here and we're getting all the options that we can possibly be getting that are rigorous and vetted and reliable.

[03:08:46] And so I just looked at a handful of states. As though Colorado, and I don't know whether we can measure this yet, but they use in their post-secondary readiness bucket the matriculation into a college or career certificate program. I don't know if we can measure that yet.

[03:09:03] But anyway, if we could maybe aspire to that one day, obviously, because that's a that's a real ready for life indicator if we've got kids matriculating to college or career certificate type programs. The other one is the Advanced International Certificate, which is one that several states use from the Cambridge.

[03:09:23] We already have Cambridge in here and that's sort of their, you know, credential, so to speak, from graduating from their program. I know that Florida uses that one at least. And then there is the some folks say you've got to get a C or better in a dual enrollment course, you know, whether if we want to just, you know, not just measure participation, but we want to measure potential grades.

[03:09:47] And then Tennessee, again, there's a bunch of these. They use the CLEP, the college level exam program. That's another one that's popular with other states. Of course, we need to have apprenticeships in here. I don't think I see that word, just, you know, approved apprenticeships, however we want to define that.

[03:10:04] And then instead of an IRC, some other states say that you can, if a child completes 300 or more hours in the same program in through dual enrollment, because some of these programs aren't tied to an IRC, but if they, you know, 300 hours is, you know, a pretty big commitment.

[03:10:21] So some folks use that as well. So anyway, just several other ways that we might pick up on readiness that other states are using. Dr. Foon. Dr. Norther, when you say IRC, I'm assuming for public purposes, you mean industry-recognized credential? Yeah, and so there's a couple misnomers I just want to clarify for those who might be watching or in the field.

[03:10:42] We have dual enrollment up there. That includes concurrent enrollment, both of those items in that space. And then we definitely have looked at other things like CLEP and advanced certificates and the availability in Virginia, but are things we can continue to research.

[03:11:00] But again, I think one of the things Anne has leaned into in the modeling here is making sure that the things on the space are measurable. So we've talked about work-based learning and apprenticeships and those kinds of things, but we also need to understand that we're not using the same measure of quality.

[03:11:18] So thinking as the board's asking us to think about some of the recommendations that you're talking about, we will need to make sure that those are consistent measures of quality across the board. So to Andy's point of, is this a three, is this a four on an AP? Each one of these, we will need support and conversation probably in June about what the measurable component of that is.

[03:11:42] And in particular, I think one of the pieces that people have talked to us about are apprenticeships and work-based learning and definitely that space. But what is the measurable nature of the quality? because we want students to have externships, apprenticeships, internships, work-based learning opportunities, but the quality needs to be something that we are able to measure.

[03:12:04] So as you are naming things, we encourage you to help us think about what the outcome measures are in those spaces. And I'm gonna turn it back over to Anne. No, I think that I appreciate those

suggestions, seeing them in other states. So I think we're, yeah, trying to balance the data that we have and the data that's also like the most common things.

[03:12:24] You know, we want to make sure we're getting the things that are really being offered across the Commonwealth most commonly for in-first. But I think when we come back in the subsequent months, we do want to be getting even more specific with these definitions. We're going to need to be as we move forward with the ESSA plan.

[03:12:41] So really appreciate that feedback. Are there questions, comments, civics? I'm sorry.

[03:12:58] So how are we thinking about civics? Because there's not a, you note that there's currently a lack of consensus. Some people think the citizenship test should be required at some point that it's a reasonable, it's a reasonable proxy and it's anyone who's taken it's a pretty, you know, covers a lot of things about our country, our government and so forth.

[03:13:21] Like, how should we be thinking about that? So I think that came up in a few of the listening sessions. And I think we heard voices on both sides. Some saying, yes, I think that makes sense to be included in the high school measures, even as a graduation requirement, not so much for accountability, but as a student accountability graduation requirement.

[03:13:42] We also heard folks saying, please do not make that a required or I don't even know that should be in high school. I think that should be lower grades. You should be able to do that. So I think that reflects this lack of consensus where it wasn't sort of overwhelmingly supported by the stakeholders.

[03:13:59] But we did hear sort of on the flip side of that pretty much universal support on the importance of community service and, you know, giving back to the community as being really more authentic that they felt like for a high school student as a demonstration of their civics readiness.

[03:14:16] So I will say here, as a part of that conversation, I think part of the pushback on the citizenship test was specifically around it just being plopped in somewhere.

[03:14:36] So, for example, there have been a couple of bills in the General Assembly to require citizenship tests, and there weren't any guardrails or any support mechanisms around that. I do and would love it if you guys looked at the Massachusetts citizenship test program, the way that they implement it, because it truly is a high school program of sorts.

[03:15:03] So it's not a do it and then you're either done or you pass or you fail. it is a support system that's built into getting that test um you know getting you to a point where you are ready to take that test as a student um you know we hope that you are when you get to high school anyway ready to take that test but in some circumstances you know there needs to be some more support there so i would encourage other board members to look at that massachusetts uh process

[03:15:36] as well their citizenship test um that they require of all high schoolers so that isn't a just take the legislation and plop it in schools and so yeah dr coons would you like us to find out the cost of that please i'm sure it's exorbitant please that was you know part online that each student has to i don't know i think it's another state they have to come in and play because i do think community service based that part is important but having been a high school

[03:16:13] teacher and dealt with students who are meeting their criteria it's good but i don't know that every student um some meet the criteria just meet the criteria that makes any sense you know it sounds

good on paper everybody's moving back to the community and they were directly or indirectly but i think it would be neater and i think something along with what you're saying would have you know more substance to the sickness but i understand it too is expense and who's

[03:16:51] going to teach it or would it be online or part online parking class you know um so i think since we're still forming some of these things you know i think there's a an argument to be made that you you know, we're not going to have this all completely figured out, you know, today or in the next weeks. There are some, we could think about, okay, you could opt in, some districts and schools may opt in to give the test and we just report it and don't count it. You know, it's just a transparency thing and it's up to you whether you want to do it or not. I just, and I would need

[03:17:30] a civics teacher to explain this to me, but I literally just read like, how do these naturalization test, how do other states do it? I was able to Google U.S. naturalization test. It's 100 questions and states, some states require, they randomly choose 10 out of the 100 and kids have to get six right. Like that's how a lot of states do that. It's that simple. And it's not a, it's not like a secret. Like it's the 100 questions of the civics test and they pick however many and that's what you get. So I don't think it's a huge cost associated with this, at least in terms of how other states are doing it. So that's just one thought. Other states are also opting in for if

[03:18:10] schools want to measure how many kids are signed up to vote. You know, that's another measure we might just think about is voter registration. And that's a pretty important thing for, you know, the seniors to do. And then we also talked about before about having a civic seal. You know, maybe it's something we talked about the opportunities to, you know, utilize these seals and maybe a child take, you know, agree to volunteer or do a service thing or whatnot. So just some random thoughts. Yeah. Dr. Kunz, do we already have a civics seal?

[03:18:51] Yes, there is one of their several graduation seals currently, and one is a civics-based or sort of service-based seal. I think that we, and I don't know if someone from the department wants So we've thought about, like you said, I think the seal is not very given very often.

[03:19:12] I think it's, I don't know how many students are actually getting it as part of their diploma. So I think we're not sure I would really add much to the differentiation of schools. That was one of the things we heard about. But if I may, I mean, the whole idea of these is there are a number of different, I mean, there are presumably not a lot of students doing the military route.

[03:19:36] that's one way to be demonstrate readiness for life. So if we have, I mean, just to use our existing resources seems like something to consider. I agree wholeheartedly on the military point. I do think we just want to be a little careful. Joining the military is a matter of choice, right? And I do, I get nervous when I hear we're going to hold schools accountable for registering kids to vote. Like, I think you should register to vote. I think you should vote. I strongly encourage it it's also though a country where not as a citizen not registering to vote is

[03:20:13] a that is a choice you can make choosing not to vote in a particular election or in any election um there's journalists who just don't vote for instance so i think we want to be it gets back to some conversations we had a long time ago on history standards we need to be very careful we're being mindful of the lines uh that exist in terms of what we need to prepare kids we make sure they know how to register to vote the importance of voting how that works but crossing that line to you must do this we're starting to

infringe on people's their own rights to make decisions about how they what they do or do not want to do i love the divergent brainstorming

[03:20:53] all those ideas not making this a recommendation just want to point out in terms of things we already have available to us and we use um there is the middle school civics test and the u.s virginia history and of course test and so these are two measures that are already there um that that i think you know are pre-existing and available that um at least should be on the dry erase board of thought and i would argue however if we're really serious about the civics

[03:21:27] measure you know i think we might i mean again i wouldn't i'm not sure i want to advocate for additional assessments but we do not have it in the course assessment for u.s government in high school um and you know just to throw that out um i do i would love to be able to see something

[03:21:55] standardized objective versus just completion on that particular item i think this is all really helpful feedback that we can take moving forward and um yeah i just want to make sure that the team has enough to bring back for june i mean i i feel like that's my job is to make sure that when we come back to june we bring what the board needs for decision points and i i feel like we had some

[03:22:30] good conversation around next steps for college and career and even some clarity around military but we got very wide on civics, so can I ask the board to come back and give us some clear directionality or at least a couple of different things that you want us to model or propose? Because you're going to need to see what this ready-for-life indicator looks like in June, and if we don't get a little bit more directionality, we're still going to be in brainstorming mode in June, so I just want to try to get us to a few options for June so that

[03:23:05] you have something to react. Well, I think you heard one thing, some options on what other states are doing. Massachusetts, obviously, just given the DNA up there and some of the organizations that are there, they've been very forward-looking on civics. But what other states are doing, how states are using the citizenship tests? We've heard some different, like, do you do a sampling approach? What states are requiring? That is sort of an objective measure that one is in. I mean, that's one of the most sacred things, becoming a citizen. So it's important, and we use it as a

[03:23:40] country in important ways. So I think some things like that. Give us some options on things that are standardized, comparable to Ms. Creasy's point. And I think with all of these, you know, going back to what we were talking about earlier on AP, that we can just link to like, to tell people, here's why this matters in life for your next step. Like there's a clear through line that this isn't just something we just kind of dreamt up, but here's why this matters to the next step

[03:24:07] a kid's going to take in life but the massachusetts in particular

[03:24:40] that's really helpful feedback and i think we can also think about too to the point um i think it might have been dr northern that raised about things that you know here in these options what might make sense for reporting purposes versus in the indicator you know there might be sort of a list of things that we think at least as a first step for transparency purposes makes a lot of a great deal of sense to be more forthcoming in the reporting side and then so i think we can think about both of those tools reporting and accountability as we bring this

[03:25:10] forward but madam president yeah uh on the uh two thoughts one on the uh the civics test uh i do think if we're going to put any emphasis on it at all we do need to make sure that our sols for those high

school courses are aligned with it and i don't actually know whether that was something we considered when we revised the history and and social you know those those hundred questions. Are we actually asking our teachers to teach that content? And I don't remember that

[03:25:48] being part of our discussion when we did the history standards revision. So the content of those hundred questions is all in the eighth grade civics and economics, but that's seventh grade.

[03:26:08] But then the question is, if we're teaching it in seventh or eighth grade, but not in 11th, 12th grade, then when is the right time to put weight on it? And I'm not sure that everything a student knows at the end of seventh grade, they also still know at the end of 11th grade.

[03:26:29] So that's just a thought. The other thing, we do currently have a work-based learning piece in our CCRI. And I think I heard you say that the feedback from the field was that that's important, but it's difficult to measure. So where, where do we, where are we going on that? I don't see it on the list, either on the left hand or the right hand side, but I see that it's on your, your, in your second bullet in career standardized work-based learning. Oh, thank you. I'm just missing it. Okay. So it's on the left side and is it on the right side? So it's, yes, we're going

[03:27:05] to keep it, but, but try. And I think the idea here is to get a little bit tighter on the guidance around what counts as a work-based learning experience towards it so trying to make it a little bit more standardized and measurable just like with the service learning experience and so is that something you're going to be able to bring us more clarity on in june on what what it would look like to make that more standardized yeah we are actually part of a national organization called launch and one of the things we're looking at with 12 other states is that space so we can have andy armstrong and claire bring that that information back because planning on doing that

[03:27:44] actually yes for you now i'll turn it back to chat all right we're going to turn from the readiness to completion and graduation and we're going to take this in two parts the first is talking about completion so uh in march we voted to include the four-year federal federally adjust federal four-year cohort adjusted i can't say that four-year adjusted cohort graduation metric that is going to be included in the new accountability system what we are asking

[03:28:21] today is feedback on whether we should also include another completion index the graduation completion index which virginia has used in its accreditation system for going on 25 years now i have some data on what the differences are across those two systems and we can talk about the pros and cons and tensions about how we might want to think about it the first uh is that

[03:28:56] so the four-year adjusted cohort graduation rate is a simple standardized measure mr rotherham made the point uh at the last meeting that virginia was a leader on developing this measure and it's comparable across states and so it's also required for federal purposes it will be required it's going to be included in the new metric you all as a board voted to include it as 15 weight for high schools the statewide for the class of 2023 that uh graduation rate in total was 89 88.8 of the

[03:29:33] cohort finished on that timeline 51.4 received an advanced studies or ib diploma 37.4 of students received a standard diploma that both counted towards it what did not count towards the what i'm going to call the fgi the federal graduation index was a few other things so one is the applied studies diploma the isaep completers geds certificates of completion and other students that are still enrolled that are calculated.

[03:30:04] And that was about 6.5% of that cohort that were either still enrolled or earning other sorts of diplomas. Just to compare the four-year adjusted cohort rates versus the GCI, the Graduation Completion Index, these are showing you a histogram of the distribution of schools across Virginia.

[03:30:27] The left is the four-year adjusted cohort rates. And I put arrows just to show you the difference, The main difference is that there's a push. The GCI has more schools towards the higher end. They get more credit because they have accounting different types of certificates and diplomas.

[03:30:45] And also they give more time for students. The two main differences are time. So beyond the four years, as well as the applied studies. Yeah, Mr. Rutherland. Thank you, Chad. Just going back to the last slide, I don't want to be that guy, but I will be that guy.

[03:31:01] this all needs to be disaggregated because the advanced studies diploma is incredibly stratified by race, ethnicity, economic circumstance. I think pre-pandemic, it was only about one in three low-income kids. It was maybe 40% African-Americans, much higher completion by other demographic groups. So I think we have to break that out to see the full story again. It's one place where the average is kind of obscure who's going on on on what path that's a good push we don't have that information for you today but that's a good push any other questions uh about

[03:31:40] this missile yeah moving to the next slide the i i just don't uh help me understand what the scale is what what's the x scale what what's the x and the y so this is essentially the rate of either graduation or completion and so so but there it goes up to 200 so no it goes so that's the number of schools that's the y-axis is the number of schools that are falling backwards yeah so the graduation rates on the far left can it's really hard to see but the far left is schools that are under 60 percent then the next category is 60 to 70 70 80 80 90 and 90 and above so what's this

[03:32:20] essentially showing is that uh the under the gci there's a lot more schools that get 90 or more of credit and there's fewer schools in that 70 to 80 and 80 to 90 range and do i remember you showing us data either in this or previously that even though the distribution is more skewed to the right on the virginia gci that uh that they're pretty highly correlated with each other they are pretty highly correlated yeah i don't uh i can't remember the exact number but what i'll show you

[03:32:55] here is again really hard to see but hopefully you can get some insights into this is i put them together so essentially each line is one virginia high school and uh across the state the gci is adding about four percent statewide to mr rotherham's point there's a quite a bit of distribution across that so some schools the gci is really not adding anything and other schools it's adding 10 or more of credit um and what's relevant for this conversation is both the overall levels as

[03:33:28] well as which schools are getting credit and um the as i as i was finishing on my point is that the gci gain is mostly from either extra time so there's the four-year adjusted cohort is four years the gci allows for additional time and it's also about the other types of diplomas again applied studies being the largest one of those

[03:34:15] basically uh that's right so the adjusted cohort is lower overall and it has more differentiation whereas the gci is higher and has less differentiation um could you go back to slide 30 for a moment chad yeah um again the way we've done things kind of treat some of these things as equals but if you look at that bottom set of bullets the additional portions i think chat touched on the time the 3 388 students re-enrolled for a fifth year that is something to celebrate

[03:34:53] and a herculean lift for those schools got their children to come back and so that that is a that is something worth celebrating and so i do believe as we move forward just for the clarity piece the federal rate is what we need to use as our cornerstone marquee piece i'm not disputing that but i just like to lift up that getting kids to come back is something worth celebrating successfully and and incentivizing similarly you know that that the applied studies diplomas seems like uh you know there there's huge victories there there are families in that 1828 who did not want their child to continue down an sol track they wanted their child learned to

[03:35:32] navigate the bus system um be able to operate their kitchen safely you know there's there's a lot of things there and those are victories so again i i think that everybody and now you've heard the feedback sessions everybody understands the federal rate it needs to be the cornerstone of what we do accountability wise but but if we really want to capture children whether those bullets move to like a readiness piece or some other way of highlighting it um a fifth year graduate is is a huge success um even if they didn't do it in four years yeah the one thing i would say mr siebert dr siebert teed up an important question for the board today so first is

[03:36:11] do we want an additional completion or graduation measure with life such as the gci and the second question is which specific how should we measure that whether it's the gci which includes the other types of diplomas or would we rather have more just a time-based question of lots of states are allowed to use the five-year adjusted cohort rate or the six-year adjusted cohort which focuses on the same diplomas but allows for extra time so those are the two questions is uh different types of degrees and diplomas and time. Sorry, hopefully that's helpful. Madam President? So maybe I

[03:36:49] misunderstood what you just said, but do the feds give us any flexibility on this at all? Did the feds allow some states to use a five-year cohort? So they have to use at least the four-year rate, but they can also add a five or six-year. They call it the extended year rate. So in other words, it would be a somewhat more complex measure because it would be, we'd have to use both measures.

[03:37:13] It would be an addition, yeah. So the four-year rate is already going to be included. The question is whether we want an additional graduation or completion measure as well. Which could be our current Virginia completion measure or could be an extended, but the feds wouldn't mind if we, we could do, we could use our current Virginia one as an additional measure or we could do a five-year completion.

[03:37:39] either of those would be acceptable for ESSA purposes. Yeah, and the way that would fold into the system would be part of the high school readiness indicator and go into that bucket. So we have a discussion later about how we want to think about potentially allocating that bucket.

[03:37:56] But yes, that's where it would go. In addition to the four-year, an additional measure of graduation completion, whether that's the GCI or an extended year cohort rate. And just also, again, still understanding the way the federal measure works those students who graduate in five years basically never get counted in the fact you know it's not like i mean it's strictly if you finish in four years you're a success and if you don't finish in four years you're off off you're not under the four-year adjusted it would be it's time bound if you have an additional

[03:38:34] five year or six year, then it's, it adds more time to it. But under the federal mandated number, those students never get, they don't get counted somehow next year when they graduate. That's right. Under the federal four years. Once they're out, they're out. Once they don't succeed within four years, then they never come back into that measure in a subsequent year. Okay.

[03:38:55] Well, I'm with, I agree with Dr. Siebert that a lot of schools put a lot of effort into those students, and we wouldn't want to give them the contrary signal that once they haven't graduated in four years, we don't really care whether you keep them enrolled and heading towards graduation in a later year. That would be an unfortunate unintended consequence. I don't think we're saying we don't care. It was a matter of that that should be celebrated, and I think that's part of the readiness piece. I think that's good. And I think the other numbers, we all understand

[03:39:34] a GED does not rise to the level of success for a diploma. So again, maybe we need to think about how those things are done. But again, that still is a success, as are those ISAEP. Those are very difficult cases who run through a really significant gauntlet to qualify for that program and to channel that. So what I like about all those bullets, although I think the still enrolled is is the big victory. And I definitely like that, you know, if we're going to put the I and IEP individualized, some children need different approaches for their education. So I like celebrating that. I saw that all those things need to be there, but it's whether we want to

[03:40:10] weight them. And I want to hear people saying they should be in the readiness category. Dr. Norland, go first. I was just going to suggest, I mean, we're not the first state to wrestle with this. So I really like Louisiana's way that they've combined everything that we're talking about. So it's called the Louisiana, it's the Strength of Diploma Index, and it combines, so we don't have to have two different measures. So once again, it's very similar to the proficiency index we've been talking about. So the four-year graduation, you know, you have to do it the Fed's

[03:40:47] way, is 100 points, okay, because it's a possible of, you know, so many points. And then if you do five years, you're 75 points. If you do six years, you're 50 points. If you get a GED, you're 40 points, and so on and so forth. And then you can go above that. You can get a diploma plus. If you get a technical credential, you get 110 points. And then if you get a dual, you know, a AB tech, whatever you want to call it. But if you Google, if you want to really want to see it, if you Google Strength of Diploma Index Louisiana, it'll come right up. And again, it combines everything we're

[03:41:22] talking about in one measure, it counts all kids. And you just make sure that, you know, you don't have to have two confusing measures. But one thing I'll say is that Louisiana does have to have a separate four-year adjusted measure. So they have that as well as the strength of diploma, sort of what we're putting on the table of whether Virginia wants to include an additional completion measure like the GCI or something like that. The GCI essentially functions a lot like the Louisiana measure. It doesn't have the advanced credit for some of the advanced awards. Right. If I may just clarify that, so what Virginia does now is similar to

[03:42:01] what Dr. Northern described Louisiana doing in our GCI, in our Virginia completion index. Some components of it. Virginia doesn't give extra points to the advanced degrees.

[03:42:18] But we do give weighted per credit towards the five-year and six-year, et cetera. Yeah, on the service, yeah, the index is similar in terms of more points towards the more standard diplomas and less weight to the GEDs and other sorts of credit.

[03:42:34] Just a quick question. Do we have information around if we did a fifth-year adjusted cohort? Do we have it readily available, or is that something we'd have to run? I've looked at the fifth and the sixth year extended year rates, and they, especially the fifth year, captured the most of it.

[03:42:59] Sixth year adds just a little bit more, but not a lot. And I haven't run it in terms of the overlap exactly with the GCI, but it would be similar. The difference would be, again, on the diploma. So the five-year rate would be only focused on the standard diplomas.

[03:43:17] So giving kids more time, but they still have to get the standard performance. That would be the distinction. So when you say, so right now, I see the data says 88%. So if we add a 50-year, that goes up to special education. Give me a little bit.

[03:43:35] Don't quote me on this, but it's something like two points or two and a half percent points. And then the extra 60-year adds another half. Thank you. That's helpful. And I think the reason I was asking that is, you know, we want 100% of our kids who graduate to have some things. And the question is what, you know, we have to do the minimum around the four.

[03:44:01] If the adding the fifth year, you know, swung us pretty significantly, five, 10, I don't know what is statistically significant, then I would be in favor of a fifth year. But when I hear you say, know it's two three percent that doesn't feel significant but if you tell me from a research perspective that is significant then i would be i as a school leader i would be excited to have a fifth year to be honest i don't know about a sixth year just like what it does developmentally socially for school but a fifth year given the pandemic and where we've come from and the like

[03:44:40] closing the gap seem to me makes sense but if it's not significant then uh you know if i worry we're getting a little off track how many of these kids who are still enrolled that we're talking about are still enrolled because they're in special education so we're required in my view appropriately under federal law to serve them until they're 21.

[03:45:02] and so they're they're i'm worried we're getting on what are some edge cases you have data on how many how many of those kids i'm looking to see mark would you know more about the civil mobile categories yeah unfortunately yeah because i'm worried we're getting i'm worried and i think something dr siebert said earlier it's really important that i something i've always struggled with on this and i struggle with it the first time we is you do want to celebrate those that is really important and particularly kids uh uh with ieps who have persevered you want to strut

[03:45:39] you want to honor that it is a powerful thing but how we think about that is like what should the policy be overall like then it becomes you know these are incredibly compelling stories and we've got these aggregate overall numbers and like i i like i think we need to find ways to celebrate that but it may be difficult to incorporate in the policy for and i worry we're i worry we're getting a little uh we're talking about population that we don't necessarily fully understand demographically. Can you clarify the two, two and a half percent that adding five

[03:46:13] years adds, that is percentile points towards the, so in other words, we have a 90% graduation rate in four years, and if we do five years, then it's 92 and a half, so it's really closing a significant part of that gap. It's percentage points, like you said, yeah, so again.

[03:46:35] reducing the dropout rate by a quarter, you know, if you flip it and look at it the other way. Dr. Norton? I was just going to make the point, 37 states use a four-year extended graduation rate.

[03:46:51] So, I mean, it'd be silly if we didn't go this direction, in my opinion. I mean, most states, to Dr. Siebert's point, have acknowledged the same thing, that we need to, you know, make allowances for kids who need longer than four years. Okay. The other category it might be interesting to know is do other

states have anything equivalent to our applied studies or our ISAEP, which is the applied studies is the other big number here.

[03:47:22] And I don't, I would be interested to know how other studies states, you know, I don't know whether Louisiana's metric counts them in some fashion or, but that's all applied studies and ISAEP are both special ed kids. Is that right, Dr. Siegert? No.

[03:47:47] ISAEP is not special ed. Applied studies is. Okay, so I don't know what that one is. But the Applied Studies one is mostly IEP kids, or all IEP kids. And so the ISAEP that we count currently, I just don't even know what that is.

[03:48:09] I just want to call out, you do have a letter from one of the people on our Interstate, Council for Interstate Military Compact, who's a bit frustrated with the Applied Study diplomas and representing a large group of military families who move children in and out of multiple states frequently.

[03:48:26] And the concept of applied studies diploma is not something the military is familiar with, because most states use something called a certificate of completion for those students. And so when they come in and they see an applied studies diploma in that public comment letter, you're going to see some frustration around kiddos thinking they can go to a community college or something else with that diploma level.

[03:48:49] So I encourage you, as you're thinking about that, to look at that public comment letter that we have. So to this point about the other states, so the key difference here is that some of the other states that have been able to count diplomas that are specifically for students with disabilities in the federal rate, the way that they have done that is that these are the students that take the alternate assessment, so they're not taking the regular SOL.

[03:49:18] they have significant cognitive disabilities and the states have shown that the diplomas these students are getting are not just aligned to iep goals but they are actually aligned to standards so i believe louisiana has done that but the virginia applied studies diploma right now would not meet that bar because it's not just limited to students who take the alternate assessment students who take the regular general assessment can also get an applied studies diploma currently and it's not aligned to the content standards to the degree that the u.s department of education

[03:49:56] would need to see so those are sort of the two differences and why um for purposes of accountability you know the gci has had to sort of sit separate from the fgi this is so and if i got that right

[03:50:18] We could do an additional measure that captured the five and six year, five and or six year graduation, but we could not add our applied studies diplomas into that measure for ESSA purposes, unless and until we actually make changes to our graduation requirements, which is not.

[03:50:38] Right now, we're just working on accountability. We can't fix, make changes to what an applied study diploma is in Virginia as part of this effort. That would have to be a separate effort. Everything that we're presenting is possible. So I think including, you know, just straight up putting the GCI into this system as part of the readiness component is an option.

[03:50:59] That is an option. Also, adding the five-year or a six-year federal rate is also an option that other states have done. You know, there are states that include GED completion in their ESSA accountability system.

[03:51:16] They just do it in like their readiness indicators. So it's an option. I think that's what we're trying to get direction here is what's the best direction for Virginia, adding no additional measures beyond the four year federal rate or adding one of maybe these options.

[03:51:33] So, maybe I'm now understanding, but I think what you just said about some other states that have essentially a more rigorous version of the applied studies, the diploma that is aligned to standards, that they actually get to count it in the federal graduation index.

[03:51:50] Yes. And that's what we cannot do based on our current, okay, I got it. So, like a Louisiana could count, I believe Louisiana has gone through this process, can count that in their four-year rate. And that's where the letter of frustration you've gotten is like, it's not equivalent across states.

[03:52:09] Yeah. Well, so what I'm hearing is that we're going to use the federal as the cornerstone, but we like the idea of counting every kid in the readiness piece. We still celebrate every child. We account for every child. We don't let anybody fall off edge.

[03:52:32] And so putting over that, again, that would be in the readiness section, not in the graduation section. Is that where we are? We can follow that. I think, President, I think, again, we're trying to figure out what's like, what is the main thing we are trying to drive towards?

[03:52:52] I think we're getting, and we're trying to drive towards, we want kids to graduate from high school in four years. Ideally, we'd like them to graduate many more of them, particularly across these huge demographic inequities we see. an advanced studies or ib diploma so i think we want to we don't want to lose like line of sight to what is what are what are we trying to encourage we can we should celebrate other things we should probably have some conversations about the frustration dr uh coons is talking about is real we recognize more diplomas than most states that create does create problems again this idea of what's the line of sight someone has to their next thing but i want to make sure we don't lose

[03:53:30] ourselves here what is the line of sight to what is it we want schools to do and ideally what we want them to do is to graduate kids in four years with a rigorous diploma that has them prepared for their next step whether it's post-secondary of different kinds the military college uh and so forth okay um what i know people are kind of fading here for food so if we can just hold here um and come back at 1 30. is that good it's 45 minutes long enough okay 1 30 please thank you

[03:54:10] um so thank you and chad i guess you're still on deck huh all right uh hopefully you all solve this

[04:43:03] uh while over lunch we're going to turn to a discussion of some input and gathering your feedback on waiting for the different components of the readiness measure so we've had this separate as elementary middle and high school and what we want your feedback and input on is how you you would think about percentages, allocation of that readiness metric across the different grade spans. There are things in here that we talked about today that maybe will reflect in this

[04:43:37] conversation this afternoon. But maybe we can start with the elementary and go through how you would allocate potential weights across chronic asmanteism and performance tasks, assuming that we can bring it back to the board with something that the board is controlling.

[04:43:58] One, I just want to bring it back to the feedback that we heard across the field. And one thing that our division data, our DDOTs, had asked for is please don't make chronic absenteeism different

weights across grade bands. So that was one thing that they advocated for, that if you have chronic absenteeism at 5% in elementary, it should be 5% all the way through.

[04:44:21] that was one piece of feedback that that we had heard in several areas i don't know if it came through in the actual letters but we heard that in the qualitative feedback the other thing is we're not going to vote on this today but we would like your sense of you know if you're willing to put out numbers for us that would be helpful in creating a model that you all can react to of uh different school weights and how they fold into a actual model of school performance

[04:44:49] Dr. Koons, why did they feel like it was important?

[04:45:08] They said, you know, as you communicate an elementary that's K-4 here or K-5 there or 6-8 or 8-12, they wanted to make sure that everybody, when I have a family member and I might have a second grader or a fourth grader or an eighth grader and I'm communicating how my performance and support framework works, I don't want to say chronic absenteeism only waits here and it waits here.

[04:45:31] They wanted to have consistency and message and clarity for the families. Madam President, I guess I hear that. My thought is that if you made it the same percentage across the three levels, when readiness is a different percentage across the three levels, we're inherently weighting it differently.

[04:45:50] I'm just playing telephone. Yeah, I just don't know how we reconcile that. Well, and unless we're ready to reconsider the weightings we've ascribed to the bigger categories, which I would be delighted to do if anybody else had an interest in that, because I think the weighting is wrong.

[04:46:09] But given the parameters of what we decided last month, the only way we could weight them the same at all three grade bands is if we, I mean, something less than 10% at each grade band.

[04:46:25] So in chronic absenteeism, it varies. There are a couple states that are as low as 3% or 4%. There are some states, I would say the typical state is somewhere in the 10% to 15% range. And then there are some states that go up as high as, I believe, 20% or 25%. So I think the 5% to 10% range is pretty standard, or you could go a little lower if you wanted to as well. And I'm speaking of elementary, I'm not speaking across all of the grades.

[04:47:06] And so is it consistent across all grades? Are all elementary, middle, high, or is it different in most states? Yeah, I don't know off the top of my head. I would say it varies probably. Oftentimes, there are more metrics in high school given the college and career readiness type of things. And so chronic expertise intends to get a smaller weight as it gets higher up in the grades.

[04:47:35] Madam President. Mr. Sturdifant? If there was a number, I would start with 5%. You know, I know our divisions are frustrated with chronic absenteeism as a metric, but I think we made a good decision to keep that metric in.

[04:47:57] Last year, last spring, the department recommended that we eliminate the chronic absenteeism metric, and we rejected that. The board, over the advice of Dr. Koons' predecessor, rejected that recommendation because we think it is such a key piece of student success.

[04:48:21] and I think it's key both independently of its impact on academic outcomes and because of its impact on academic outcomes. And I know Mr. Hanson, who's not here, felt strongly about that at the time, and as did I. And so while I understand the divisions would love to have it be lower, I'd hate to see it

lower than 10%. Now, again, in elementary school, we can't make it 10% unless we maybe allocate, bump up to 15%, God forbid, the readiness metric for elementary school.

[04:49:00] Perhaps we can talk about the high school. We can start there. We've finished up right before lunch of talking through the different weights of completion or other graduation, extended year graduation components. Since it's a bigger category, maybe we can start there. Are there thoughts about how you would allocate the chronic asenteeism, the new readiness for life measure, as well as any sort of other completion or extended year graduation measures?

[04:49:42] Throw out some straw man, because I feel like we got to get moving here. My straw man is elementary, 5-5, middle school, 5-5-10, and high school, 5-20-10. I'm just like filling in blanks. Elementary, I'm just...

[04:50:06] put in 5-5. Middle school, I did 5-5-10. I'm just going down our slide here. And then high school, 5-20-10 for your debating pleasure. So elementary, five chronic absenteeism, five performance tasks. Middle school, five chronic absenteeism, five advanced coursework, 10 performance tasks. High school, five chronic absenteeism, 20 career ready index, and 10 graduation rate.

[04:50:46] - Madam Chair? - Please. - Thank you, Dr. Northern for getting us moving. On the middle school one, I think we talked a little bit today that we're just not sure what a middle school performance task would be yet, whether we could spin one up and how much one would cost. So maybe that should be, just maybe flip your percentages for advanced coursework and performance task.

[04:51:10] Yeah, five, 10, five. Again, just throwing that out there. - We do not have to settle on these today by any means. We are gonna use them as initial weights we will come back to you all with but are there any strong objections that someone wants to make a case for something very different what uh either dr siever or dr northern put out well so i mean i just would love to ask our practitioners but to have chronic absenteeism i mean our schools have been working so hard to get the kids into class and have made progress but it's been hard and tough

[04:51:48] and it's just such a key measure so directly responsible for what i see is our continuing pandemic loss. And is 5% enough for school divisions to pay any attention to it? I mean, it's almost like at 5%, they're just going to go, oh, well, we asked. We asked this question in our sessions that we had so many people. We had less numbers than five in most of the conversations. So if you're asking us- Well, that's because they don't want to do it.

[04:52:21] Well, Ms. Houlton, you would like to ask our practitioners, what I'm saying is we did ask our practitioners in the listening sessions that we had over 600 participants online and over 200 plus participants in person.

[04:52:38] And there is, as we talked about on the onset this morning, angst around understanding what it would do. So it might behoove us to do some modeling. Oh, absolutely. Absolutely. And I'm not disrespecting the input. I very much value the input. On this particular indicator, the input we've gotten from the field for some years now has been, make it go away. And I think they're wrong about that. And I think I am concerned that this 5% is effectively making it go away.

[04:53:14] I just would like to push back gently on a couple of things. I think make it go away, I think, is an overstatement. I think the fact right now it's an indicator that can turn off the lights from the whole

accreditation system is the problem. So I don't think there's ever been a problem with reporting it and saying it's important.

[04:53:33] I also don't think at 5% it's going to be ignored because it is so highly correlated with all the other indicators. We don't have children in school. They're not going to succeed in mastery. They're not going to succeed in growth. They're not going to succeed in any of those other tools. So I don't think it would be ignored, and I don't think anybody wants it to go away.

[04:53:55] People just want it right-sized. Ms. Holton was saying earlier how we always disagree. This is one where we don't. I agree, and I am concerned about the waiting there, too. I have a question, though, for Mr. Alderman based on that. I'm concerned here we're tossing out these numbers and a phenomenon we've seen on accountability systems we certainly saw the teacher evaluation is let's have a bunch of measures but they don't actually vary that much and so then you end up with a couple measures that do vary and they take on contra what are the peers they end up taking on disproportionate wave i just use like a crude example if you have 20 indicators each worth five points you have 100 point scale but if only like

[04:54:34] two of them move you effectively have only two indicators in in practice and i'm how given how some of this stuff correlates even with some of the data we saw in graduation. While there's a distribution, it was a fairly tight clustering. How should we be thinking about that? Because I'm worried we may be, in effect, creating a measure that we may not be creating a differentiation that we're looking for. Obviously, some of that will come out in modeling, so I don't ask you a question. You may not, but just if you have any ways for us to think about that. Yeah, I don't have an answer for you today. I will say I wrote it down in notes. It's something that we will

[04:55:12] definitely look at and bring it back to you when we do have models to look at if there are no other strong reactions on the potential weights here what i will do is turn to this slide and talk about next steps uh i don't know this i saw was asking me if we had clarity on the high school graduation completion metrics anyone have any insights over the lunch break that you really want to stay for the good of the group that would be helpful for us as we think about modeling this

[04:55:50] How would you think about including the GCI as it currently exists or including an extended year cohort rate or have neither any strong reactions to those three potential rounds? Which is one board member, the graduation completion index, unless we revisit the waiting, I have trouble using it a lot, just given how it's weighted towards.

[04:56:15] I mean, granted, the GED numbers we saw, they're relatively small, but I think we need to be waiting towards four year completion. and I'm more interested in making sure we also just have really honest reporting on who's getting what kind of diploma and what that looks like across the Commonwealth. May I? But just to be clear, we are waiting towards the four-year completion because that's our graduation index measure. So this is what additional graduation index we're going to look at. And the simplest thing might be, for the short term anyway, to just continue the current Virginia GCI, which everybody knows and understands as we're changing so many other things. I could definitely

[04:56:54] go with the five or six year completion rate as well, but that does worry me that we don't yet have a replacement for those special ed kids who are working hard to get the current applied studies diploma. And that's maybe something we can fix at some point. But in the short term, my instinct would be. And what we're hearing from the field is they want the GCI in there somewhere.

[04:57:23] Dr. Norther? I mean, I guess I would just welcome feedback around the Louisiana example that I gave. You know, I thought that that, in my opinion, threaded the needle. So I don't know if Ms. Holton, if you think that threads a needle or not, you know, in terms of taking care that we count every student, that would be one suggestion. I just think the CGI has been problematic and we need to meet that federal definition. And I really do think this is a good way that we simplify the system by having a graduation index, but it still pays attention to that five and even six year

[04:57:59] extended rates that some kids may need. Just to be clear, I'll offer the federal indicator as the graduation measure. Oh, okay. I'm not sure I get that.

[04:58:22] Chad, I just make one other quick comment on chronic absenteeism, just for the record. And I know I'm standing out on a limb by myself on this one, and that's fine because sometimes we just got to be that way. But if we could continue just to explore the concept of a chronic absenteeism growth measure, because I think that also addresses some of the concerns that the field has and that we've articulated here and that I do think our SAS folks have done that in other states and could possibly explore that for us as well.

[04:58:54] Preston Creasy, can I just clarify, what would a chronic absentee growth measure be in a one-year accountability, or is it over-multiplecy? Okay, thank you.

[04:59:14] Okay, I don't hear consensus on that. Maybe we will keep talking on the potential completion and graduation components and what that could look like. And maybe hopefully modeling will help as well. What we can promise going forward is a system model.

[04:59:32] So we are working towards that with some of the decisions we've pointed to today. I don't want to use decisions as in pen, but at least the sort of input, the feedback we've gotten today will help us build those models. And then we'll be writing out a full revised Every Student Succeeds Act state plan, the ASSA plan.

[04:59:52] That will include a lot of these details. And that will be a process as well over the summer. There will be a public comment process for that document as well. That will be a lot of the specific items that I think the field will be very interested in to follow up on.

[05:00:09] But that is part of it as well. We'll also be talking to U.S. Department of Education on some of these proposals. Make sure that they are okay with it. We think we haven't put anything in forward with you that would not pass, but that is part of the conversation soon. I just want to thank the board.

[05:00:26] The conversations today, I know that we have had a lot of conversations and talked to a lot of people and got a lot of feedback, a lot of written feedback, a lot of conversations. We continue to have several more feedback sessions, but this information on specifically where you want us to go with modeling, where you want us to get ready for the June meeting is incredibly helpful so that we can actually get exactly what you want to make decisions in the process so that when we come to you in June, we have decisions that we can move through all of these processes. And I think the ultimate point that we have heard very clearly

[05:01:02] back in the field is they want this finalized in September so they can run their current system for a whole year and see what the new system is and how it would look and how it would impact so they have a whole year with the new system to react to and figure out how to prepare for that. And I think that's

an important space for our schools as they're looking to something that's changing and something that has more rigor and more clarity in it is to be able to prepare for that.

[05:01:28] So I just want to thank everybody for the time, for the commitment, for the discussion, because I think it's incredibly important for us to have multiple conversations, but to try and get this for our school divisions in September. So they have a whole year to look at this as they're preparing. So I really appreciate everybody's support and assistance.

[05:01:46] And I want to give a huge shout out to Chad and Katie and Mark, who have probably put thousands of miles on our road warrior moments, trying to make sure that we are hearing as much as possible from the field. So I just want to reiterate my thanks.

[05:02:02] I'll give a final preview of where we're going. So I'm excited for the conversation right after this will be about Virginia Department of Education's support system. So we've been talking about identifying schools for support. What will those supports actually look like? We'll talk through what's going on now and what's the plan for the future. We're also going to be back tomorrow talking about how to think about how to identify how many schools and how to provide them support.

[05:02:24] So we haven't talked about how to set points and thresholds, but we're going to have some of that initial conversation tomorrow as well. So with that, I will turn it over to the OSQ team that's going to talk about the support system.

[05:02:54] I'm all my friend. We're going to go to B, where I'm B. B as a boy. So I'm just incredibly proud and honored you've met Dr. Katie Carroll and her work around performance and support, working with Chad and Ann.

[05:03:23] But one of the important things at the agency is that our performance, our accountability, our assessment measures, as Mache has said, our overall health. But this is our support. And talking about how we're thinking about performance and support framework could not be a full conversation unless we talk about the great work that Dr. Albin and Quentin have done to really lean us in here.

[05:03:50] Dr. Ballard has been boots on the ground with our school divisions across the Commonwealth, and Dr. Alvin has really been working to reshape our team. So they're going to ask me to kick off the front line, but I want them to be up in the face of this work because they really are leading how this transformation is happening with our school division.

[05:04:12] So I'm not sure who has the clicker. Yeah, there you go. Awesome. Well, we've talked about this a lot this morning and we've talked about the performance and support framework. And what I really want to lean into is under our current system, school divisions frequently have to do a state accreditation plan and a needs assessment and a support for that.

[05:04:32] And then they also do a federal plan if they have identifications in TSI, ATSI, and CSI components. And that's a whole lot of planning and a whole lot of compliance and a whole lot of support that these two gentlemen are managing. So if there are two people that are most excited about putting these two plans together, they are leading the team that is most excited of moving from planning and checking the boxes and making sure dollars fit which box.

[05:04:59] It's really transforming this to how do we actually identify needs clearly and transparently, talk about the overall health, and then lean in with supports. And they have worked really hard to move us into

this new support framework this year and have worked with our school divisions across the Commonwealth to talk about these four areas.

[05:05:19] So when we all came into this work, it was a choose-your-own-adventure support framework. You want to do this? You want to do that? You want to do this? It was, we'll support you whatever you need. And what we really wanted to do was look at what the current research around, quote unquote, school turnaround said, and where were the areas we wanted to lean into.

[05:05:39] And what research is telling us right now, the four levers that truly move a school with support around a deep, clear, coherent academic support plan with clear support and strategies that focus on the instruction and the instructional quality.

[05:05:56] Second, as we've talked a long time on this board, is how do we ensure that the staffing is there, that the high qualified licensed staffing is there, and that they are there not only for the teachers, but all of the community in the school. So the principals, the support staff, everyone is highly licensed and highly qualified, and that there is a focused effort to making sure that happens and not a patchwork quilt of let's just get someone in the seat in the school.

[05:06:24] And then third, how do we grow that staff? How do we grow the principal? How do we grow the support staff? How do we grow the teachers? And make sure that the professional learning, as we all have heard in the education community, is not a one-stop-and-done, but a continuous approach.

[05:06:40] And really, in the professional learning support cycle, we are talking about helping the operational supports, making sure the quality of the building, the safety of the building, the operations are efficient, And that they don't lean into the effective operations of the classroom, really supporting on our instructional support cycles.

[05:07:00] This is something our teaching and learning team is digging into, is what do we do to support teachers around using high-quality materials? What do we do to support teachers around delivering instruction with those high-quality materials? And how do they get feedback?

[05:07:16] One of the most clear pieces of research right now is making sure teachers get regular and consistent feedback in the classroom. So this lesson planning, instructional support cycle, and really leaning into support with our principals, our specialists, and our teachers to build the time and the schedule, but also have those support structures is an incredible focus of this.

[05:07:37] We actually, Brendan, has a Literacy Implementation Network grant out right now to launch these instructional support cycles with several school divisions, and so we're excited to launch this work coming up. And then the career development and making sure that we're providing that deep professional development and that sustainable and retention component for both our classroom staff, but also our principals.

[05:08:03] What we are seeing in our high needs environment is a cyclical situation with principals in and out of the door. And that means we have newer principals in high needs environment. I want to talk about that for a second. We have a program launching in June in partnership with VA ESP and VASSP.

[05:08:23] And we have 24 principals, new early career principals in our high-needs school who will receive year-long coaching, 12 elementary principals through VA ESP and 12 secondary principals through VASSP. And that will launch in June.

[05:08:40] We have worked with our superintendents of some of our high-needs areas to identify school principals who are early career principals in high-needs environment, and then we are working with VAESP and BASSP to develop programs of coaching support, and we'll be excited to talk about that at the end of next year because we'll be looking at impact and program evaluation data and the impact of that work.

[05:09:02] So really excited to dig into growing our staff, both our teachers and those upper buckets, but our principals and really thinking about the depth and sustainability of principals in the school systems. And then the fourth component is school climate. We spent a lot of time on and off talking about chronic absenteeism and attendance supports and how important, as we've shared with data, that having schools have engaged students are incredibly important. The Office of School Quality has been very connected to attendance works. They're also connected to Joe Worf and

[05:09:40] some of the work he is doing around attendance, but also really deeply engaging our families and making sure our families are engaged in the work. We have the Office of Parent Engagement, but that work is extensive and comprehensive and the work that Brendan and his team are working to build out. So those are the four buckets of focus that we have shifted towards in the Office of school quality to make sure we're not doing more of a scattershot school improvement generalist approach, but really digging into those four areas. What are the academic supports of school

[05:10:16] needs? What do they need to build that strong instructional program? How do they make sure they have a high quality teacher and a high quality principal in those seats? I believe we have a couple of different growing programs that are in the office of school quality specifically to support staffing development? And then what is that long-term professional development that really deepens the retention component? First, giving teachers feedback in the classroom on a continuous and regular basis, but also supporting our principals and developing principal capacity in our high needs school. And then fourth, what is the overall school climate? What is the

[05:10:54] attendance? How are we engaging families? And how are we supporting families and being part of the instruction. So I'm going to pause there because Brendan's going to dig into the how of this work, but I wanted to kind of go over the research design and the research embedded, the evidence-based approach that we have shifted towards in our school improvement framework. Questions? Yeah.

[05:11:24] I'm going to turn it over to Dr. Albin. Excellent. Thank you so much. So good afternoon, President Creasy, Dr. Koons, members of the board. I am Dr. Brendan Albon. I'm the assistant superintendent of the office of school quality i am joined by dr quentin bellard who is the director in our office we are exceptionally proud to be leading this work particularly as the new accountability system is coming into place in virginia to be able to change our focus under the direct leadership of dr coons of moving from compliance more to being support in the schools we really see our roles as being able to come alongside schools help them to identify their

[05:12:03] needs, and then help them work through developing a support plan that will be continuous, and then to be able to access some federal school improvement grants, implement some evidence-based interventions, and to be able to annually take a look at that plan and to improve it. As you see, the Department of Education is taking a holistic approach to how we support schools. All schools very much under the MTSS model are going to be supported. And the tier one, those are division supports that are covered by all offices in the agency, be it teaching and learning, be it

[05:12:41] special populations, regional supports, going to schools, helping them with their needs. The office of school quality really comes into play more when you start to get into your tier three and some of your tier two schools and some of their needs. So typically your tier two schools are the schools that might be those who under accountability measures have prioritized options for network supports and they need to implement some accessing some federal grants as as well as

[05:13:16] taking a look at some state options these are schools who are targeted support assistance schools and they often have a one-year kind of like a big blip this has come up on on your model we are able to support them, tie them to some grants, be able to help them to write their plans.

[05:13:35] They do share them with us. We coach them through that process. We get them to the point of being able to move on and out before they go a little bit higher. Yeah, and I know we have talked tier one, tier two, tier three. Obviously, our Department of Teaching and Learning leans in and provides tier one opportunities for all school divisions and supporting all school divisions across the Commonwealth. What we're thinking about really with tier two is this kind of bleeding space where we know schools that are struggling have prioritized opportunities in the networks and some of those resources and making sure that they get that prioritized access

[05:14:15] and some of that softer touch supports. But as Brendan's team really digs in, that's the difference between tier one is all schools across the Commonwealth, all supports. As we think about tier two. And as we talk to you and you help us shape what this looks like, we are thinking softer supports in tier two, prioritized access, consultant type roles. But then as Brendan moves into tier three, this is really the deep support. And so as we have this conversation, we're really excited to think with you about how many schools, what schools, what types of support, what kinds

[05:14:54] of resources as we build out the performance and support framework. Thank you. So under the new framework for support that was just shared with you, the Office of School Quality will have the primary responsibility of supporting those schools who are our Tier 3 schools. Now these supports are available to schools that are identified for comprehensive and assistant targeted supports under the Federal Identification Program, along with divisions under the new model of memorandum of understanding. So through this work with OSQ, these schools would be working

[05:15:33] through a needs assessment, taking a look at how they got to where they are, developing a problem statement, and then being able to tie that to what supports do we need, what interventions do we need to put into place to move on and beyond. So what we've done is we've grounded our work in research and we are working with a continuous improvement process. These school improvement plans are not just a one and done. Our ultimate goal, like our children, is to say we want to move you from A to

[05:16:06] B this year and then B to C next year under this continuous improvement process. So the work of continuous improvement requires a commitment to a process that is collaborative. We ask school principals to work with their division staff that has not always been the case to come side by side with the office of school quality to guide them through this process we're asking to build a team that would direct what that's going to look like it could be parents could be central office could be the principals teachers then they take a look at their data they take a look how did they get to

[05:16:42] the point where they are they identify what their needs are and then they take a look at some evidence-based interventions that are going to be very targeted to their students one size of instruction does not fit all and one size of intervention does not fit all different schools have different groups of

students who for different reasons have needs so it's working with those schools to be able to specifically work out what intervention is going to help that specific group then they develop their plan they implement their their evidence-based intervention

[05:17:18] A key thing that we ask all schools to do is when they get to the end is to evaluate. How did it go? Do we adapt this? Do we carry on with this? Do we throw this thing away? Was this a waste of our time and money? Very often in Virginia, we just keep doing and keep adding, keep doing.

[05:17:35] We ask them to evaluate. Did this work? What do we need to change for the next year? Essentially, once a school gets into that cycle of continuous improvement, it's not a new big thing each year. it's a system of continual growth so to that vision we know that schools in Virginia at this moment are currently identified under two systems of accountability and accreditation and these are weighted according to student academic performances that are set against two

[05:18:10] separate systems of measure using calculation tools which focus on many similar and different foci. So as you've heard, these two systems have also led to two differing systems of support, which is confusing for schools, localities, and the state to be able to support. How can we help when there are basically football and basketball going on at the same time? So this visual depicts the two competing lists that the Office of School Quality gets to work with under the accountability, identified schools, and the accreditation-based schools. So as you'll see, some schools are

[05:18:48] are currently identified under only federal identification. Some schools are identified under only state accreditation measures, but we do have many schools who do rise to our consciousness because they're identified under both of those systems. So whoever they are, we are working with all of these schools and we're working through that entire process that was shared with you to develop a support plan and to be able to work out and beyond of that. So as

[05:19:21] you can see, there are about 750 schools currently with whom we work. 250 are only identified federally and about 748 or so, or yeah, 752 are identified through the state accreditation system.

[05:19:42] A key point to note is that the federally identified schools have access to school improvement grants from the U.S. Education Department for the implementation of evidence-based interventions. Meanwhile, schools over on the green side who are identified only through the Virginia accreditation system, they're still required to develop a plan and to implement interventions.

[05:20:07] However, they, more often than not, only have access to local funds to being able to implement those plans. Yes, ma'am. So just to be clear, right now you're working with the 509 plus 243.

[05:20:24] You're working with about 40% of our schools at some level. Yes, ma'am. So just putting a pin in that, we are identifying more than, you know, we've said that only 7% of our schools are accredited with conditions. but you're working with a lot of schools that are yellow or red on one indicator or another and therefore require your intervention beyond the accredited and conditioned school exactly we are working with some schools who have level twos and level threes and over time if you have multiple level twos with certain student groups then you become a school that that we work

[05:21:02] with and then again just to understand that these are this is a helpful diagram but if i'm right it's a little bit off on the proportions because really most of the schools almost all of the schools that are federally identified now are also stated so really those circles ought to be the 243 in the middle ought to be almost correct i just couldn't get the text okay gotcha because there are only currently really our our

virginia accreditation system is pretty much identifying all the schools in the federal accountability system plus more so some of the interesting ones

[05:21:41] that where we do have some federally identified schools or some who get very close of we've had a conversation today we've spoken about the federal graduation index there are some other things to note down the road much like um no childhood behind there's not necessarily just a set pass rate 70 percent pass rate per math down the road many of the federally identified schools at 72 percent and then a few years later 75 percent so even though they do appear to cover all of the schools federal is going to start to pick out a lot more schools just based on those

[05:22:20] individual assessments with time and and dr albin this is our current right essa we are talking about completely redoing that entire structure so that they come together. So current ESSA has some challenges. Current state has some challenges. These are just current systems that aren't translating to clear lines of support and numbers aren't clear. And like you said, there's different components that go 70, 75. We noticed a large number of schools going into TSI solely on chronic

[05:22:55] absenteeism this year so there are a lot of things that are swinging all over the place both in the federal system and the state system is that correct that is correct um one thank you so much for the presentation i think that i i really love the continuous circle i think that um you know basically summarizes the whole approach and i think what i would want to emphasize for us as a board and for those who are listening is i think the accountability system and the conversations

[05:23:31] we're having on data is going to be the best tool for any school division principal teacher to actually make the most the best decisions and right now where i'm experiencing this is that there's so much data coming at divisions and principals that they're not exactly sure where to go through in terms of this continuous improvement system and while i looked at that left slide where it's like you know everyone's you know 243 or somewhere in between here i think that it's um it's important for us to think about the potential positive impact of the accountability

[05:24:09] system and being able to really hone in on which schools and divisions need help And that the I guess the one question I have in this is how how do we think about divisions versus like individual schools in terms of providing supports?

[05:24:30] And then how do we think about how we support, you know, like we don't have unlimited resources. how do we, in terms of staff and team, think about supporting leadership in divisions to be able to do the work at the ground level versus going like directly to teachers? Does that make sense? Yeah, and I think that's an important conversation for us to be having as we're thinking about the supports and the support work, because right now there's a lot of identification driving at the school and not a lot of identification driving at the division and

[05:25:05] the division supports needed. There are plans in statute at the school, there are plans in statute at the division, and not necessarily the correlation. I think that's true across the nation. As people have wrestled with how to create that balance, we in this state have MOUs, but we don't have the equivalent of a CSI school division, whereas school division is a tier three school division that needs support. And I think that's part of the conversation that they're going to have is where do you cross over from a school to a division and what's that balance that you have? Because as we have seen in school work, you can get a really great principal pull a school

[05:25:45] really far, but if that principal leaves that school and the system and structures will fall back behind. So I think there's an important dynamic that as a board, as we think about performance and support, we need to be very intentional about what it is for schools, but also thinking about what it is for divisions and what kinds of supports go in both places.

[05:26:04] So as they talked about the tiers, we've had a lot of conversations, but we're excited to collaborate with the board. Yeah, thank you. So the other thing tied to that question is we have had many conversations this year with school divisions, asking school divisions to develop a division support plan.

[05:26:22] How are you going to play a role in supporting your schools? Many divisions have schools with the same issues, so how could they help support those schools as they are implementing their interventions or even sometimes why is it in their school division this school is showing this data and that showing that how can they at the local level be able to touch support and come alongside historically they've often been the office of school quality has spoken directly with schools and we've they in some cases they've intimated that the division wasn't supporting the implementation of this intervention. So we're trying to include more

[05:27:01] voices in that conversation with the divisions as they do that. So just a very important perspective is the Office of School Quality is not the old Office of School Improvement. And as Dr. Coons very clearly pointed out to you and me when I moved over to this office, is that our role is to be the support, is to be the coach, is to come alongside school divisions. We're not the ones identifying schools we're just simply the ones saying you've been identified how can we help and we help them to develop a plan to find those great interventions and to implement them so with

[05:27:40] for us the work to develop the new performance and support framework will greatly support our office it gives us a very simple targeted guidance is how we are able to come alongside schools and divisions as they do that. With one system of support focused on the largest number of resources, the Office of School Quality will provide a deeper support to divisions and schools with the greatest need. In other words, it's no longer a mile wide inch deep, but it's maybe a little bit more, you know, 20 yards deep, 20 yards wide. Additionally, the coordinators and the specialists

[05:28:18] in the Office of School Quality will continue to be assigned to work directly with specific school divisions and schools as the point contact as a measure of customer service for those schools. Team members have been clustered within the regions and to work with those schools as well as other offices in the agency. And what all of this work does is it allows for a sustainable support system that you saw in our cycle that will help us to support school divisions across the commonwealth to work with familiar partners at the doe on more of a it's not richmond versus

[05:28:57] us we're going to be in their business collaboratively coming alongside with their growth plan on a year-to-year basis as they work through their support plan thank you any further

[05:29:09] questions.

[05:30:09] that that, how many different, uh, how much data do you need for that, and how much data you've got, what are you going to do with that? Back to your hands. Yeah, so we're going to ask several questions tomorrow.

[05:30:28] There's a whole presentation on the the components of how to measure what we're going to do, the number of schools, what that looks like. important conversation is what do our schools need, not are

we staffed, are we not staffed, but the whole point of this work is to understand where our schools are, where the overall health is, and then determine our current funding and what we need to be able to do that. So right now, we went from 93% to 90% accreditation. We're overstaffed technically. So how do we make sure that our system defines our overall health and what our schools need, and then what is the

[05:31:04] definition of support and what is the definition of what the office of school quality is so at this point in time we're not prepared to answer that question we really look forward to the modeling conversation tomorrow to be able to get guidance from the board on where the directionality you want us to go to make sure we can provide those supports appropriately to the schools who need the support we're going to be talking with the board about how you want to identify schools and whether and what that approach is and there's a presentation on the agenda for tomorrow

[05:31:41] I'm sorry. With our current accreditation system in the state level, what we need to do is better understand how we want to identify our school's needs before we understand the staffing and the support.

[05:32:26] So I would encourage us as a board and as the board to understand your accreditation, the performance and support framework before we ask these gentlemen to make crystal ball decisions on whether or not they're staffed or not staffed.

[05:33:22] And currently, Ms. Holton, what we have presented to the board, what we've presented in other places, and what we're seeing is our schools, our school divisions, and our office are turning dollars back in because of the bifurcated system and the duplicative system.

[05:33:47] So we need to fix the system so that we can drive the dollars that we do have to the supports that are needed before we identify additional supports, because right now we're sending a lot of dollars back. And so we need a system that works to identify needs, to allow our school divisions to dig into needs so that we can use the funds that we have and the federal dollars that are appropriated so we're not carrying over funds from year to year and our schools aren't sending funds back.

[05:34:13] So we need to more appropriately understand what our system and our overall help is so that we can identify the appropriate needs and the appropriate supports and drive the dollars to those needs. So just two pieces. One is I'd love to see the amount of that money being turned back because, yes, absolutely, we want to capture that, but compared to some realistic measure of the need.

[05:34:37] And I think you will find if you look at the research that says our most challenged schools need 30 to 50% more resources than the state average, then I think you will find that those federal dollars that are getting turned back are quite small.

[05:34:52] And therefore, part of what we need is some state-based resources to be directed to these most challenged schools. That's the first piece. The second piece is one of the things I saw coming through the comments from the field was concerned that actually part of what we're doing is targeting the existing federal resources towards our media schools, which I applaud and understand. But then the divisions are asking us, well, what about the rest of us? So, you know, if we're going to have a, are we going to actually have less resources to the tier two schools than they're getting now, because we're concentrating,

[05:35:31] As we perhaps should do is concentrate more of our resources in the tier three schools, but what's left for the tier two schools, we heard that a lot from the field, and especially since we're going to be putting more accountability pressure on them, what are we going to, where are the new resources going to come from, both for the state office, but also for the school divisions to help all the schools improve.

[05:35:54] Well, I'm incredibly grateful to the General Assembly and the governor who dedicated $438 million this fall. And we are watching our school divisions dedicate that and implement that extremely well. Jeremy and I had the opportunity to see all in presentations at VASH yesterday.

[05:36:12] And there are 15 different roundtable discussions about how they are using those dollars and really driving those dollars. So I think our school divisions are using tier one resources very well at this point in time. And if I may, I think that that 400 plus million all in money was a terrific boon. It was one year money only, as you know, it is not in the future budgets. So I believe the school divisions have three years. And if we look at the website, there are most school divisions using those for all three years. It was one time money, but they had some flexibility to

[05:36:49] spend it over time. But that's not the same as ongoing resources that they can use to hire teachers, for instance. May I ask a clarifying question? How much federal money did we send back? Was it 43 million, Dr. Coons? Off the cuff, I think it's 49, correct, Katie? It's been 49 over five years. Okay. That's real. Even on an annualized basis, that's real money. And collectively, that's a lot of money. $10 million a year compared to this amount of need is not a lot of money.

[05:37:20] Well, I would say both those things are true compared to the amount of need. It's not a lot of money, but where I grew up, $10 million is an awful lot of money. My question is, and we may want to hold this until tomorrow. It actually builds on a point Ms. Holton made. And if you want to hold it until tomorrow, we get the framework to just tell.

[05:37:39] But the question is, basically, I do worry the track record of sort of turning around and addressing the lowest performing schools, the most challenging, is actually not good. That's not just here in the Commonwealth. That's across the country. You saw that with the federal SIG dollars during the Obama years.

[05:37:59] We see this again and again. And yet you've got this cohort of schools, maybe the ones that Ms. Holden was just referring to, who they have needs, but they're like, hey, you know, you can sort of see a path. You can see, you know, instructional coaches, some changing in teachers curriculum.

[05:38:15] You can sort of see a path where they can go from kind of where they are to to being stronger. How should we be thinking about that? Because I do I do worry we can disproportionately focus on places where we may need to be thinking about other kinds of remedies for the students there or more dramatic kinds of turnarounds.

[05:38:34] And then these schools that they need some help and they can kind of, you know, they can kind of move up. they get overlooked is that is that a better question for tomorrow we get into the models or is that a question for today well i do think um as dr kunz is pointing out we are looking at tier two in terms of what we are able to do with state resources and it might be that this year it would be all in it might be uh grow your own opportunities that are available for everyone for example dr kunz already alluded to we're working with a principal mentorship pilot in the following year that type of program will be open to other school divisions as well the difficulty that we

[05:39:14] have is we would love to be able to have the resources to support all of the schools however what where we've been living for the longest time is we've had resources for that smaller group but we've had compliance for everybody and it's a challenge to be able to say you have to do all of this but you can't help that's where we've been many of these years the difficulty that we have particularly with those federal

dollars to be only allowed to spend those dollars in federally identified schools we're also only allowed to keep five percent back to stop our office or to do the

[05:39:46] very few things so of those federal funds we don't have the control over that much of that very often just comes down to school divisions we're not being able to expand that and return that right i think one of the other things we need to look at as an agency and one of the things that we're excited that m cooper is coming to help us do is she will oversee the federal program dollars the title dollars and those kinds of things in um an audit we have seen a lot of use there that could be driven more into our school needs and supports um you know title 2a dollars have a lot of

[05:40:22] professional development sustainability and the professional learning supports a lot of title one dollars we just offered an opportunity for 20 schools and title one spaces to be able to to go to a national conference and work on those instructional support rounds. So we're really driving our dollars into this framework and making sure that all dollars go to, you know, our schools in those different tiers. So it's about restructuring how we support schools and making sure we're driving towards a coherent braided support system. I would love to have us look at the states that we are looking at that we think have done good work helping the most

[05:41:02] challenged schools improve and there are states there it's tough everywhere but there are states that have had success helping the most challenged schools improve and see what they've done in terms of state resources because i don't think we're going to see you know we can identify problems all we want without resources that make it possible for our our challenge schools to get a high quality teacher and a high quality principal in every classroom and in every building And it's, you know, all the identification isn't going to help without resources.

[05:41:36] Yeah, Ms. Holden, I am hearing you really loud and clear, and I just have to overemphasize the overwhelming amount of data and information and priorities and direction that schools experience.

[05:41:57] that by simplifying what is priority and where supports will be, I think that lifts a tremendous lift off of school leaders, teachers, principals, divisions. So I wouldn't underestimate that is, I think, my point. The second point, and I think the data that is outlined in the document, I'm like reading it and downloading it because I'm about to send it to a whole bunch of people, That is really awesome.

[05:42:29] The best strategy to get the best teachers is through leadership and principal training and development. That is the number one factor that keeps teachers, that recruits teachers, that develops teachers. And so I don't think it is just money and resources and throwing things.

[05:42:49] I actually think that's overwhelming, that less is more in terms of priorities. And so I guess my bigger point is, I just don't think we should underestimate the value of clean data that sets priorities and then give school divisions and principals and teachers the freedom to do something with it.

[05:43:13] Right now, my sense is everyone feels like their hands are tied and people are working really, really, really hard that if we can set some priorities and give them the, like, give them the roadmap, be transparent, I just believe that that is going to empower our teams and people and bring the much needed resource, which is people, not, not just the money, but I also say, you know, more money is always good when people say is less money. I don't think that's true, but I,

[05:43:48] But I just think we have to give our people the tools to be great. And I think the accountability system, the framework, higher standards, those are all the things that I think are going to unleash the

potential of Virginia's leaders and teachers and families and increase transparency.

[05:44:10] We haven't talked a lot about it, but the role of parents in everything that we're doing is fundamental and all the news says parents don't understand either how good or how bad or how they can help their kids be better and i think again like another resource that we just have gotta make sure we're mindful of so i i'm hearing you and i but it's it's it's very hard when you hear like this is not going to work because we need more money and resources when i'll tell you what

[05:44:43] teachers want is like more like time off or like a mental health break or just tell me what to focus on because you're throwing so many things at like that's what that's what i'm hearing and i think we've got to stay connected to like what's happening on the ground but thank you i just i hope these are three quick points um one is i would love to hear and maybe we're planning on doing this from the schools who have been in these support categories in the past what's been most helpful to them, what they really need. I like to hear definitely from the ground

[05:45:20] in terms of, you know, how it's been in the past, how we really need it to work in the future, and just getting lots of input from the folks. And then rising up some proof points, illustrations in the form of case study narratives, you know, that we can share broadly across the state. Like, here's what this place did and here, you know, write up these little case study narratives would be hugely helpful. And videos of strategies that have been successful, these can be short little you know two or three minute videos so i'm underscoring the point that we have some of this expertise and already and experience in the state and i'd like to hear from

[05:45:56] those folks um two in terms of what's been um helpful uh in the past and other states and um in localities you know as we all know nclb had four big buckets of sanctions the most effective sanctions that's been studied to some success is that was the restructuring one um which involved an element of replacing, honestly, staff and principals and changing a lot of the talent out.

[05:46:22] So I would agree with Ms. Ashton that putting more emphasis in terms of the needs of our teachers, giving them opportunities to, you know, visit other schools that look like them, that are doing really good things, and having a principal who's really effective travel around to other, you know, do a six-month internship or whatnot to learn from other schools that look like them and have it together a little better. Offering teachers the opportunity, for instance, for more pay if they take on more students and they're highly effective already. I feel like we need to get out of the box a little bit in terms of what we see other states doing and making sure

[05:46:59] that we're offering divisions some ideas of the potential of how to maximize the talent of their staff because that is such a key lever. We know that the teacher and the principals are key to this success sequence. So just in terms of how do we maximize the talents of teachers and give districts some ideas of how to do that better. Madam President. Yeah, I want to just underscore one thing that Dr. Northern just said, which I think is really important. We can look at other states, but there's contextual factors in those states. In fact, a lot of the places have seen

[05:47:36] the best success with turnarounds. They've had a high degree of choice as well as a piece of that. That's not something that's going to be on the table for us. And so I think we're going to have to figure out what works here in the Commonwealth with our context for doing this.

[05:47:51] And I want to underscore the conventional wisdom that you will hear, including from some of Dr. Northern's colleagues, is that the President Obama's turnaround, the SIG program just didn't work. But if you actually dig into the data, that's not true. The light touch stuff did not work and kind of bounced off schools.

[05:48:09] But the interventions that were much more sustained, the more substantial restructuring and persistently low performing schools actually had a reasonable track record. But most of the money went for the light touch stuff. So it created this illusion that nothing works when, in fact, the real signal when you dig into it is what works is really fairly dramatic stuff.

[05:48:28] And so I want to make sure we don't, as we think about, and this is where, you know, we're talking about tier three schools, you know, substantially in need. that we we bear that in mind and we don't do stuff that just bounces off because it is possible to spend a lot of money and sort of bounce off of the of the problem and again we have to be cognizant of what are the contextual factors that are present here that may not be present in some of the other states that have seen success doing other things so just responding to both dr northern and mr rotherham i i would love to have us hear yes more about what helps and what what

[05:49:06] That doesn't help from our schools that have been in the most intensive support categories here to help us figure out how to move forward. And likewise to hear from experiments elsewhere, Andy, the areas that have had intensive interventions, what intensive sustained interventions that produce results, what does that look like both in Virginia and outside of Virginia, and how do we replicate it?

[05:49:34] And I bet the answer is going to be it is going to take restructuring of accountability, but also going to take resources at both the state and the local level. But maybe not. So let's learn. Thank you, Dr. Albin. Thank you, Dr. Ballard. We appreciate you.

[05:49:53] Do you want to do C because Dr. Ballard needs to stay up there? Yes. Okay, Dr. Ballard, we're going to talk about updates on MOU. So we're going to have you hang out up there for just a minute. So item C is our memorandum of understanding between school divisions. And as we know in the Commonwealth, that's our most significant area of need. And that isn't necessarily a tie to the accreditation model or the system.

[05:50:21] And we are hoping that as we go through this process and think about support frameworks and we talk about those school divisions who need the most support and some of that conversation, Michelle, you said about schools and school divisions. how do we think about our memorandums of understanding? We do want to provide an update, and I do want to shout out Dr. Ballard. He has been intimately involved with our MOU school divisions and oversees the direct support of our five MOU school divisions. We do plan on bringing

[05:50:53] a couple of quick updates in June to the Richmond Public Schools MOU and some of the criteria there, But, Dr. Bell, I don't want to put you on the spot, but you have been doing some significant work with Petersburg in particular.

[05:51:09] Do you want to share any updates on that in general? Yeah. Good afternoon to Chairman Creasy, Vice Chair Hanson in his absence, to Superintendent Coombs, members of the board.

[05:51:28] So with Petersburg City Public Schools, at this point, we've been maintaining since the announcement of transition at the division leadership level. Their current division superintendent is

transitioning as of April 30th with a new acting superintendent that's recently named take effect May 1st.

[05:51:48] We've maintained certainly weekly touch points, support calls and checking in. gone down a couple times to actually meet with uh division level leadership as well to really get a feel for roots on the ground what kinds of supports are needed in in the midst of uh the transition that's happening right now um and so there has been uh a number of supports that have been been provided uh through the office of accountability uh through the office of data services around product absentees and support in addition to that even through the student assessment

[05:52:25] office as well more recently as well as teacher and licensure and working through just some of the support requests that the division has certainly asked for at this particular point particularly you know you just heard me talk about teacher licensure this will be i believe now with the acting superintendent at least in the last 36 months this will now be about the fourth superintendent that will be in this division um currently if you count the acting superintendents uh so when i came in at the agency dr petrie martin was the superintendent

[05:53:04] she transitioned then they named it interim acting superintendent who's now transitioned it is in a different division in virginia right now serving as superintendent and the current superintendent was named and now scheduled to transition and so what we're seeing is transition that's happening on the staffing front uh it's a very real thing and uh that the division is wrestling with both at the division level as well as even at the school leadership level so we talked about principal support and the importance of having uh a school principal there um so many of those schools as well has seen some transition in the administration at the school level as well

[05:53:42] So we're working, again, collaboratively with the current leadership that's there, as well as the board chair of the board to provide support as they work through this transition period at this time. Dr. Vance. And I really appreciate, Dr. Ballard, I want to shout out President Creasy.

[05:53:59] We all met with Petersburg when they made the announcement about the outgoing superintendent and the intent for the acting superintendent. We had a great collaborative session on supporting them with the national search, and we plan to support the school division with the national search.

[05:54:17] But some of the conversations around the framework today, we've talked to them about additional intensive supports for both their central office and their teams around academics. We have prioritized some support around staffing and given them two to four seats in the principal mentorship.

[05:54:36] And so we are continuing to lean in at the highest level around that support framework, in particular with Petersburg. I've had several of you ask about how that was going and what that was. So I wanted Dr. Ballard just to take a minute to provide an update around that. And we'll probably be leading the MOU restructure and conversations with the MOU with Petersburg.

[05:54:57] So I really want to thank Dr. Ballard for his leadership, but also just wanted to give the board a quick update on the level of support we've been providing for Petersburg. the past couple months thank you for that work um it has had they had i know they've been working you you identified the turnover in superintendents it's just heartbreaking um and you identified school leadership i'm not sure whether you said vacancies or turnover but issues with consistency of leadership at the school level i know they've been working for many years at

[05:55:36] trying to address teacher retention and and trying to improve the numbers of fully licensed teachers as opposed to provisional teachers have they made any progress on that so we actually had our teacher licensure director of licensure go down and sit down with their director of licensure a couple weeks ago do an audit for them when we sat down we we reviewed that audit made recommendations we're actually working with a couple of partners with their board chair and have some applications in to support them with staffing but because we don't have final decisions um i would hold off on

[05:56:11] giving what next steps are with petersburg until we have final decisions on that so i hear you as to next steps but i just remembering we had a presentation from them several years ago the petersburg team came up and presented to us with um osq or its predecessor and shared the programs they were implementing to try to keep their provisional licensed teachers once they got licensed have they seen any results from that it does not appear that that is the i mean that's correct i i would concur with uh superintendent coos and uh there there is a new uh director of

[05:56:48] human resources right now that just transitioned into their role just to kind of speak to uh you know the internal first and uh new leadership so within the last 60 days uh this is a a new director of human resources that's currently serving the division so so but the the leadership the turnover in leadership is also turnover in the front lines teacher turnover as well is is still unusually high in petersburg i would say that it's a priority and focus area for petersburg just as it is for many of the school divisions across the commonwealth to ensure that every classroom has highly qualified teachers and not only to get them but to retain them and keep them

[05:57:28] and so it is important to your point around adding support resources but i think it's equally as important because there are people there who have been there for several years we need to make sure that we don't forget about them and why they stay so why people stay to serve in these divisions and in these schools is equally as important and so it's not an either or but an end both that we need to work on and that's part of the support work that we're eager to do with this new framework that allows us to kind of really make sure we're connected to that and be efficient with our efforts. Dr. Ballard, I really appreciate that comment. I would just like to give you a little

[05:58:05] bit of personal empirical research from my teacher friends all over the Commonwealth. And it used to be years ago that, yeah, I want more money. I want more money. I'm not paid enough. I'm not paid enough. And I think those who stayed in the profession really from the pit of their soul believe in what they do every single day for kids and families. And at this point, I am

[05:58:36] really dismayed that the main reason people are leaving a school or school division is around leadership. And so what we can do, I mean, there have been teachers who've been offered $10,000 more to stay. That's crazy. And they've said, no, I can't stay with this particular leadership or the turnover or the this or the that. And there, I mean, I think that we just have a really great opportunity here to grow really good leaders. And so what you just keyed

[05:59:15] on on why teachers are staying why you know those few are have been there for you know six eight ten years whatever it is whatever the length of time how can we grab that desire and also commitment and have them serve as that leadership opportunity within the school whatever that whether it's you know principal leadership or you know being a team leader in a grade level or a department, whatever it might be, but it is very clear that across the Commonwealth, the leadership

[05:59:51] is really important to our recruitment and our retention. Can I just build on that? I just have a straight up empirical question. Do we know where these teachers are going to have any data? Are they leaving teaching or are they leaving teaching in Petersburg and going to other divisions?

[06:00:11] That would be information that we would look forward to working with this new director of We've got sources to evaluate and explore so that we can speak to the current status. So what are some points that we can celebrate and what are some things that we need to kind of work on to certainly amplify our efforts to maintain, you know, the highly qualified teachers that are there.

[06:00:39] Thank you. Okay, Mr. Chapman.

[06:01:10] Thank you. Good afternoon, President Creasy, members of the board, and Superintendent Coons. The next item is a discussion on the board work plan, and you may recall that the work plan that was circulated around March of this year, in early March of this year, was really an outgrowth of the board's comprehensive plan.

[06:01:33] So on December 12th of last year of 2023, the board approved its comprehensive plan from 2024 to 2029. That stemmed out of conversations in the July board meeting of last year, the October board meeting, the November board meeting, and of course culminated with its approval in December.

[06:01:50] And as part of that process, the board expressed an interest in having a little bit more robust idea, a one-year snapshot of the types of things, the types of items that would move before the board. And so in March, staff circulated kind of a first draft of this work plan.

[06:02:11] And the work plan that you have is organized around the comprehensive plan's priorities, what the board identified it wanted to focus on for the 24 to 29 period. And so priority one is high expectations, priority two is focused on learning loss, priority three, as you've just heard about, is high-quality licensed teachers, priority four, innovative pathways, priority five, safe schools and behavioral wellness, and priority six, a student-weighted funding formula.

[06:02:40] And so, in accordance with, I believe it was at the March meeting, the January of the March meeting, to have some dedicated time to discuss this further, we have this work plan for you and on the agenda and would love to open that up to discussion and feedback. Okay, now's your time. Ms. Ashton?

[06:03:08] I think it was my first board meeting where we discussed this and I thought, well, can someone just outline where we're going to go so I can predict and this is exactly it. So, thank you. Anything else? Ms. Holton?

[06:03:26] Yes, thank you. Very helpful. I have one structural suggestion that I think would help us, and this is particularly on the board work section. The pink and the gray up top are more, I think, the department work, but our work is all at the final part of the work plan, if I understand it correctly, in the blue. Is that the right way? That's how I understand the distinction.

[06:03:51] I don't think so. Um, Dr. Coons, if there's a, yeah, help me understand what's above. Yeah. What's in the, what's the blue, yellow, and the color codes are your, your priorities that you put in, in your overarching. And then across the board, you're seeing where the months are, where you're going to have presentations. You guys asked for presentations, asked for some school divisions to come in. So we mapped that out for you across the year when, for example, we can't present on chronic absenteeism.

[06:04:23] data today because there's no data to present on. So we mapped out when we would have strong data so that we could provide opportunities throughout the year around those priorities that would make sense. So each color represents one of those priorities. And in the bottom, those are the statutory actions that you have to take in the rhythm of those actions in the bottom part.

[06:04:45] Okay. I think that helps me understand. A lot of extra data. And so we want to make sure the board had a complete picture of all of the items, regular and otherwise, that we expect to be part of the board's work over the next year. I do think to the extent structurally you can align horizontally the items, and I see what you're trying to capture here, but it makes it very complicated now to see that the, well, just on the final, the very end of it, the award of school construction grants, it shows up in april at the bottom of a on the bottom row and then shows up at june for final

[06:05:24] review on the top row so to the extent you can align horizontally first and final review on items i think it would help us understand i i certainly appreciate that i can tell you we do have a draft where we did that it was like 25 pages long yeah okay but but you know given that we're looking at them all electronically i almost i mean i found it hard to follow from from march to june but and it may be that there are things that are on there that i can't find because i'm having a hard time following so maybe give us both versions if if you if if you still have the draft but maybe

[06:06:02] that's it's too hard but that's just one uh visual request um and then a second a couple of substantive ones one is um the i see unless i'm missing something i see the first discussion of cut scores coming up in january with the first review of the recommended cut scores i think we need before then some discussion of revisions to the process for setting cut scores if i'm right expect

[06:06:37] you know we have a standardized process for setting cut scores articulation committees and I can't remember what the there's two levels of expert panels that review the cut scores before they come to us and I understand that there is some appetite on the board to change that process.

[06:06:56] I remember a particular suggestion from you Mr. Rotherham some time ago that if we're going to still have those articulation committees that we need to maybe make some change to the composition of the articulation committees to include uh college level people not just high school level so for that just by way of example so should we as a board be planning for a discussion of revisions to the cut score setting process before we start setting cut scores yeah i think we have that in

[06:07:32] our more granular piece but we're happy to put that in this calendar yeah and and so when does that fit in and obviously it would need to be sometime well before january 25th if because you all are going to you for whatever process we approve i think we have that in october but we're happy to add that well but we need to do it even before october right because we need to approve the process in time for you all to then carry out the process in time for january so that would be one and then the second is that the textbook reviews and i'm not sure where we are on did we

[06:08:07] review math textbooks in march already we reviewed in textbooks and did not have enough um that came back for comprehensive so they're back out for review and we'll have them this summer you're going to have a presentation we haven't actually approved any textbooks yet they are there you have a presentation this month on thursday so we will see the the textbooks themselves no you will see the new timeline on Thursday. Okay. So I think we need to incorporate those timelines, the textbook,

[06:08:44] because that is a big responsibility that we do, that the divisions look to us, need us. You know, the divisions can adopt textbooks that aren't on our list, but to do that, they have to go through their own whole procurement process, which is quite burdensome for our smaller divisions. So they that textbook process is an important responsibility of this board and we need to see that I mean the tradition anyway is we see the actual textbooks at one month and have an opportunity to look through them and then a final do a final review at a subsequent month and so I

[06:09:24] can we make sure that's fully integrated into this schedule and I think I'm right that what I'm hearing so so that's my my first question on textbooks is and maybe it's already on here and I'm just missing it so yeah I see it on for April but that's no longer accurate because that would mean we're we have a discussion up for April but okay and obviously when when you asked us to do the board plan we did it on a schedule right and that's going to evolve over time right and this is the board work plan for discussion today at the retreat obviously we have an item on the agenda

[06:10:03] for Thursday, based on that feedback, we'll probably need to revise the board work plan, and that is going to happen over time. So, yeah, and I'm not saying it's inaccurate in the sense, it was accurate when printed, but now it needs updating, because it says we're going to be approving final review of math textbooks this month, and now I do remember, I look, now I think you all have got us approving final review of math textbooks, something like January of 25, Does that sound right?

[06:10:32] I can't speak to that off the top of my head. It's well into next school year. I don't think so, but your presentation is on Thursday. Well, so after Thursday, maybe we can come back and revisit this, but I do think that's an important responsibility that needs to be properly reflected in here.

[06:10:49] And then if we're not going to approve math textbooks until well into next school year, and I think that's what the schedule says, then what are our schools doing this school year? Are they just using old textbooks even though we've got new standards, and does that work?

[06:11:11] Bashton, I'm sorry. I guess I thought this work plan was a guide for us to engage thoughtfully in strategic conversations and decision points, and I think, Ms. Holden, what you're saying is that there are points on there, but we're not actually making decisions in this draft or proposed timeline.

[06:11:40] But I think that's okay because our work is iterative and that we're getting feedback and we're asking for information and that this should be a plan that we use to make sure that we're, you know, marching through things. but if i'm off on what this plan is then i would love to clarify because i i that's that's what i assume we were asking for and um again i think the questions are right but i just want to understand what the plan is how do we use it as a board to make sure we are doing the work of the board dr northern and i'll just reiterate that that's what i and when i brought some of this up that's

[06:12:18] what i wanted it to be too sort of strategic and not reactive and us really being able to chew on some of the struggles that the state is having our schools and districts and even the agency is having so the one piece of um i guess feedback i would give like some of these questions read like updates you know like what does the data say about learning recovery that that sort of sounds to me like we're going to get a presentation about what the data says about learning recovery which is fine but i think you know in terms of us just tackling and trying to brainstorm and really get at some of the meat of personally why why i love being on this board is um more maybe like how do

[06:12:54] we improve the working conditions in our schools you know we know that a lot of schools are having trouble with discipline for instance or why do teachers leave and what more can we be doing about it you know again an opportunity for us to engage and trade ideas and hear from the field um so anyway it's just it's a little bit less questions about updating us and giving us another presentation and more of a pointed question where we really try to dig in as a board and try to brainstorm and come up with some feedback. And it doesn't have to be an hour. It can be a 15-minute or whatever that ties into, obviously, what we're going to be doing. But anyway, that was kind of,

[06:13:34] I was kind of with you, Ms. Ashton, on kind of what we were looking for. And that's what I'm looking for, too. And so I don't mean my comments to be critical at all. I think this is our chance to make sure this document helps us guide our work across the end of the year. So for instance, we don't want to get to January of 25 and go, oh, the department's gone through a whole process of cut scores according to an old process, and now we need a new process. So that's the kind of strategic thinking I think this is designed to help us do.

[06:14:07] But I do think that the textbook approval process, it fits into our whole, you know, We've adopted new standards. We're implementing new tests. The textbooks is an important step along the way in that, and it needs to fit into the chart in the right place. And I am seeing it. I'm pulling up the reports that we're going to see on Thursday, but they have us approving the math textbooks in January of 25 and approving the literacy test textbooks in August, though that's not right because we don't have an August meeting.

[06:14:41] But anyway, I just want to get them on the charts. I do think that those textbooks, so I would recommend that we ask as improvements to this chart that we update items like the math textbooks that have been postponed and help us show where they are going to be on, and so this be a continually evolving chart.

[06:15:12] Any other comments? Thank you, Mr. Chapman.

[06:15:24] Okay, so we are moving on to item E. That would be Ms. Love. So, okay, do you have the motion? Yeah. Can we take a five-minute break before we, or almost 10, I guess? Yeah. Dr. Northern has a motion for us, please.

[06:26:45] I move that the Virginia Board of Education convene in a closed meeting for the following purposes, consultation with legal counsel employed by or retained by a public body regarding specific legal matters requiring the provision of legal advice by such counsel pursuant to Section 2.23711A8 of the Code of Virginia and that legal counsel to the Virginia Board of Education staff whose presence will aid in the board's consideration of this matter participate in the closed meeting. Move. Bye.

[06:27:23] And then that's what I think. Yes, second. Okay, this is the board. Hi, hi.

[06:27:41] I think we're good. Hi, hi.

[06:27:50] Stay in a closed meeting pursuant to a recorded vote on the motion above

[07:27:09] and in accordance with the Freedom of Information Act. section 22-3712 of the code of virginia requires that the board certify that to the best of each member's knowledge one only public business matters lawfully exempt from open meeting requirements under this chapter and two only such published public business matters as were identified in the motion by which the closed meeting was convened were

heard discussed or considered any member who believes there was a departure from these requirements shall so state prior to the vote, indicating the substance of the departure that, in his or her judgment,

[07:27:45] has taken place. The statement of the departure will be recorded in the minutes. Ms. Ashton? Aye. Ms. Kilgore? Aye. Dr. Northern? Aye. Mr. Rotherham? Aye. Dr. Siebert? Aye. Mr. Sturdifant? Aye. Ms. Holton? Aye. And chair votes, aye.

[07:28:05] before we conclude for the day i just wanted to um make sure that everybody saw the agenda for tomorrow there is an update to the future cases so page number two is been removed so you guys are aware of that yes last night it wasn't loading for me yeah nothing added okay yeah no no no nothing down. You'll just see application. Anyway, then you'll see on our schedule. I'll be speaking to

[07:28:40] this. Sorry. You'll see on our schedule for tomorrow that we are hearing from all of our lab school applicants that have been sent from the standing committee to the board. They will be doing their presentations. Please note that this is the time for you to ask your questions of those lab school applicants because Thursday is our business meeting on those items.

[07:29:03] So please make sure that you do your homework and you are ready for any questions that you have for those applicants tomorrow. And that's all for me. Do you have anything? I want to mention that on Thursday, we are in double letters on our business meeting agenda.

[07:29:20] So we have a lot of items and this is our busy time of the year. So in advance of the next two days, I will say thank you. We also have several groups coming tomorrow. We are honoring our administrative professionals at the agency at eight o'clock. These are the lovely ladies and gentlemen who are taking decades of paper materials that have been housed in the James Monroe building for comfort and going through those and determining what needs to be kept, what needs to be saved, and what can

[07:29:57] be um permanently removed and what needs to be digitized and they have done just an outstanding tremendous amount of work over the past couple months so i'm really excited that we get to recognize them we will have student performances again and hope to continue to have student performances um consistently in this building as we've moved to old city hall but we will also recognize several different groups over the next couple days and i'm really excited for this board to have the opportunity.

[07:30:24] Back in December, you gave us feedback about having the opportunity to have more people in. And now that we are in our new home, I'm excited to really make that a robust opportunity for all of us. So thank you guys for honoring the work and letting us bring some people in and celebrating the great things that people are doing across the Commonwealth.

[07:30:42] And for the breakfast in the morning, will we be on the fourth floor? Where will we be? Yeah, fourth floor. Well, what about we're going to be in the department of offering breakfast to be in this great professional? no that's no that's what I was referencing yes which where is that fourth floor we only get to borrow this room on the first floor for board meetings so most of our all of our events are up on the fourth floor okay I would love to say that there are spaces bigger but that is the standardized big space for this building



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